For every user

User Guide

Aperture Chat

Everything you need to work in Aperture Chat: chat, model access, personalization memory, documents and decks (including Word and PDF files, templates, and the slide editor), account sync, agents, knowledge and tools, automations, search, account security, and reporting a problem. No prior knowledge assumed.

31 sections · every instruction spelled out step by step

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PART 1

Getting started

1. Welcome

What Aperture Chat is and how to read this guide.

Aperture Chat is your organization's workspace assistant. You can chat with approved AI models, draft documents and slide decks, search your organization's knowledge, and schedule recurring work. Review the sources and work trace when a response uses connected knowledge or tools.

This guide explains where to look and what to choose. Words in bold — like **Save version** — match the labels on screen. If a step says “hover”, rest your pointer on the item without clicking; controls that offer extra help show it nearby.

How each task is taught

Each task appears in three matching forms: a narrated walkthrough video in the product, a written procedure in this guide, and the same procedure on the website guide. They come from one source, so they describe the same steps. Every walkthrough is a complete loop, from where you start to a result you can see, and it covers each way the product offers to do the task.

IN EACH WALKTHROUGH BOX	WHAT IT GIVES YOU
Before you begin	The role, access, earlier setup, and outside accounts or values you need first.
Step by step	Every action in order, with the exact labels on screen. Where there are several ways to do the task (an identity provider, a delivery target, a device), each path has its own complete list.
Check that it worked	What you should see when the task succeeded.
Troubleshooting	Messages you may meet, quoted as the product shows them, and what to do about each.

Walkthrough screens are real captures of a running workspace with sample accounts. Steps that happen in another product, such as an identity provider's console, are shown as labeled instruction cards rather than imitation screenshots.

GUIDE	WHO IT IS FOR	WHAT IT COVERS
User Guide	Everyone	**Chat**, model access requests, personalization memory, documents and decks, account sync, agents, knowledge and tools, search and commands, appearance, account security, and reporting a problem.
Administrator Guide	Workspace admins	Everything in the User Guide, plus the **Admin console**: users, groups, model access, connectors, response actions, **SSO**, analytics, support tickets, policies and memory governance, personal data protection, training datasets, audit, and alerts.
Platform Owner Guide	Platform owners	Everything in the other guides, plus setup readiness, providers and keys, organization policy, the connector ceiling, branding, releases, search indexing, and platform governance.

TIP

If a feature is not configured — a connector without credentials, a model that is not enabled — the screen reports that state. Ask your administrator about account, model, or connector access; workspace connectors are configured in **Admin console** → **Connections**.

2. Signing in

Reach the sign-in screen and get into your workspace.

- Open the web address your organization gave you for Aperture Chat in a modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, or Firefox).
- On the sign-in screen, type your work email address in the field marked `you@company.com`.
- If your organization uses single sign-on (**SSO**), the screen recognizes your email domain and offers **Continue with SSO**. Click it — you are sent to your organization's identity provider (for example Microsoft or Google), sign in there as usual, and return to Aperture Chat already signed in.
- When both methods are offered, choose Organization **SSO** or Email & password. The password field appears in Email & password mode; enter your password and click Sign in. Pressing Enter submits the method you selected.

GOOD TO KNOW

If both **SSO** and a password are available, either works. If your organization enforces **SSO** for your email domain, password sign-in is blocked on purpose — use the **SSO** button.

GOOD TO KNOW

See a message you do not expect? The sign-in screen reports real problems plainly (for example, a domain that is not allowed for **SSO**). **Copy** the message and send it to your administrator.

WALKTHROUGH · 3:50 · HELP › LEARN

Request access and enter your workspace

Ask for an account, then sign in with a temporary password, your own password, Organization SSO, or an authenticator code.

Before you begin

- Your workspace address, which your organization gives you (for example https://your-instance.example).
- Your work email address.
- For Organization **SSO**: an account at your organization's identity provider, such as Microsoft Entra ID, Okta, or Google.
- For a password account: the temporary password your administrator gives you after approving your request.
- If two-step verification is on for your account: your authenticator app, or one unused recovery code.

Step by step

1. Open your workspace address in a web browser. The sign-in page opens.
2. Under New to Aperture Chat?, choose **Request access**.
3. Enter First name, Last name, and Work email, then choose Submit access request.
4. Read Request received. The form does not send an email or set a password. Contact your administrator, who approves the request and tells you how to sign in.
5. When your administrator gives you a temporary password, return to the sign-in page and choose Email & password (it appears beside Organization **SSO** when your workspace offers both).
6. Enter your work email and the temporary password, then choose Sign in.
7. On Set a new password, type a password of at least 12 characters into New password and Confirm password, then choose **Set password** and continue.
8. Check that the welcome card, A good place to begin., says You're signed in.

Path: Organization SSO

1. Open your workspace address. Organization **SSO** is selected first when your workspace offers it.

2. Optionally type your work email. It selects your organization's provider, shown as Sign in with followed by the provider's name.
3. Choose **Continue with SSO**.
4. Sign in on your identity provider's page, including any multifactor check it asks for. Aperture Chat never sees that password.
5. You return to the workspace signed in. On your first visit your account is created automatically if your organization allows it; otherwise ask your administrator to add you.

Path: Email & password

1. Choose Email & password.
2. Enter your work email and your password, then choose Sign in.
3. If two-step verification is on, follow the **Authenticator code** path.
4. The workspace opens where you left off.

Path: Authenticator code

1. After Sign in, Two-step verification asks for a code. It shows the attempts remaining and when the challenge expires (about five minutes).
2. Open your authenticator app and type the current 6-digit code into **Authenticator code**.
3. Choose Verify and continue.
4. No phone? Choose **Use a recovery code instead**, type one unused recovery code, and choose Verify and continue. Each code works once.
5. If the challenge expires, choose Back to sign in and start again.

Path: Trouble signing in

1. Choose Trouble signing in? under the sign-in button.
2. For Organization **SSO**, use your organization's own password recovery.
3. For an email-and-password account, ask your workspace administrator for a temporary password.
4. If you lost your authenticator and have no recovery codes, ask your administrator to reset two-step verification for your account.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The welcome card A good place to begin. shows You're signed in.
- ✓ Your name appears on the account card at the bottom of the sidebar.

✓ With Organization **SSO**, the identity provider's page handled your password and you returned signed in.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Invalid local credentials."	The password is wrong. Retype it (Show password helps), or ask your administrator for a new temporary password.
"Unknown local account."	There is no active password account for that email yet: the request may still be pending, or your account signs in with Organization **SSO**. Choose Organization **SSO**, or ask your administrator.
"SSO is enforced for this email domain; local sign-in is disabled. Use the configured identity provider."	Your organization requires single sign-on for your domain. Choose Organization **SSO** and **Continue with SSO**.
"Use a password with at least 12 characters." or "The passwords do not match."	On Set a new password, use 12 or more characters and type the same password in both fields.
"Choose a new password."	The new password matches the temporary one. Pick a different password.
"The MFA code is invalid." or "Too many MFA attempts."	Wait for the next code in your authenticator app and check that your phone's clock is set automatically. After too many attempts, wait for the timer, or choose Back to sign in.
"Verification unavailable"	The sign-in challenge expired or was used up. Choose Back to sign in and sign in again.
"Too many failed sign-in attempts for this account. Try again shortly."	Wait a minute before trying again, or use Trouble signing in?.
"Too many access requests for this email. Try again shortly."	Your request was already recorded. Contact your administrator instead of submitting again.

3. Request access and finish your first sign-in

Submit a request, understand the administrator handoff, and enter the workspace.

1. On the sign-in screen, choose **Request access**. Enter your first name, last name, and work email, then submit the form.

2. The Request received screen confirms submission for your email. If this email is new to the workspace, an administrator reviews the request. This form does not email you or create a password.
3. Contact your administrator for an update. After approval, they provide the workspace address and confirm whether to use organization **SSO** or a temporary password.
4. Choose Back to sign in. Your submitted email remains filled in. Use the sign-in method your administrator arranged.
5. If you received a temporary password, sign in with it and complete Set a new password. Enter a new password of at least 12 characters twice. After saving, the app continues with a new authenticated session and revokes your older sessions.
6. Complete any required authenticator verification. **Once** in the workspace, select an available model and send a short first message. If no model is available, ask your administrator to check your account, group, and model access.

GOOD TO KNOW

Submitting another access request does not approve an account or recover an existing password. Trouble signing in explains the recovery path: contact your administrator for local password access, or use your organization identity provider for **SSO**. If sign-in settings cannot load, choose Retry connection.

4. Two-step verification and recovery codes

Set up an authenticator, complete required verification, and manage recovery codes.

To add an authenticator after signing in with a local password, open your account drawer, find **Security**, choose **Manage security**, and select **Set up authenticator**. Confirm your current password, add the QR code or setup key to your authenticator, acknowledge that you added it, and choose **Verify authenticator** with a current six-digit code. **Copy** the one-time recovery codes into secure storage, acknowledge that you saved them, and choose **Done**. Copying alone does not store them for you; finish verification and code storage before leaving the panel.

- If sign-in asks you to set up an authenticator, choose **Begin authenticator setup**. Add the displayed QR code or setup secret to your authenticator app.
- Confirm that you added the account, enter the current six-digit **Authenticator code**, and choose **Verify and enable MFA** before the setup expires.
- Use **Copy recovery codes** and save the codes privately when they are shown. They are not saved to a file automatically. Each recovery code can be used once when your authenticator is unavailable; do not include these codes in screenshots or issue reports.
- On later sign-ins, enter your current authenticator code. **Use a recovery code instead** switches to a single-use recovery code when necessary.
- If you cancel or the challenge expires, return to sign-in and start again. A cancelled setup or failed verification does not finish sign-in.

When verification is enabled, the account card shows how many recovery codes remain. **Replace recovery codes** requires a fresh authenticator code or an unused recovery code; after replacement, all previous recovery codes stop working. Save the new set before leaving the dialog.

Turn off verification appears only when your organization's policy allows it. Confirm with an authenticator or recovery code; successful removal signs you out. Organization-required verification cannot be turned off here.

If you lose both the authenticator and all unused recovery codes, contact your administrator for the organization's verified recovery process. A new password does not remove the authenticator requirement. For identity-provider MFA, use that provider's recovery process.

TIP

Use the code currently shown for this workspace in your authenticator app. If it expires while you are typing, use the next code. Read the attempts, expiry, and any cooldown shown; wait for a cooldown to finish before trying again. If **Security** cannot load, choose Retry security settings. Keep setup keys and recovery codes out of shared documents, videos, and support attachments.

GOOD TO KNOW

SSO accounts manage voluntary authenticator setup in their identity-provider settings. Your identity provider may also require its own verification during **SSO**. Follow the provider's screen for that check; these instructions describe Aperture Chat's authenticator screens.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:51 · HELP › LEARN

Protect your account and recover access

Turn on two-step verification, sign in with a code or a recovery code, replace recovery codes, and change your password.

Before you begin

- An email-and-password account. With Organization **SSO**, your identity provider manages your password and multifactor settings, and the panel says so.
- An authenticator app on your phone, such as **Microsoft Authenticator**, Google Authenticator, or a password manager with one-time codes.
- A safe place for recovery codes, such as a password manager.
- Your current password. If you still have a temporary password, replace it first.

Step by step

1. Select your account card at the bottom of the sidebar. In the **Security** card, choose **Manage security**.
2. Under Two-step verification (Off), choose **Set up authenticator**.
3. Enter your Current password and choose Continue setup.

4. In your authenticator app, scan the QR code, or type the Setup key shown under it.
5. Tick I added this account to my authenticator., type the 6-digit code from the app into **Authenticator code**, and choose **Verify authenticator**.
6. Choose **Copy recovery codes** and store them somewhere safe. Tick I stored these recovery codes somewhere safe., then choose **Done**.
7. Check that Two-step verification shows On and Your authenticator is connected. 10 recovery codes remain.

Path: Sign in with a code

1. Sign in with your email and password as usual.
2. On Two-step verification, type the current 6-digit code from your authenticator app.
3. Choose Verify and continue.

Path: Sign in with a recovery code

1. On Two-step verification, choose **Use a recovery code instead**.
2. Type one unused recovery code into Recovery code and choose Verify and continue.
3. Open **Account** › **Manage security**: the count of recovery codes remaining has gone down by one.
4. When few codes remain, replace them.

Path: Replace recovery codes

1. **Account** › **Manage security** › **Replace recovery codes**.
2. Enter a current **Authenticator code** (or choose **Use a recovery code instead**).
3. Choose **Create** new recovery codes. The old set stops working at once.
4. **Copy** and store the new codes, tick I stored these recovery codes somewhere safe., and choose **Done**.

Path: Change your password

1. **Account** › **Password** card › Edit.
2. Enter Current password, then a New password of at least 12 characters, and the same in Confirm new password.
3. Choose Update password and wait for **Password** updated.
4. You stay signed in here; your older sessions on other devices are signed out.

Path: Lost or replaced phone

1. Sign in with your password and one recovery code (**Use a recovery code instead**).

2. If your organization allows it, choose **Turn off verification**, confirm with another recovery code, sign back in, and set up the new phone.
3. If verification is required by your organization, or you have no recovery codes left, ask your administrator to reset two-step verification for your account.
4. After the reset, sign in and set up your authenticator again.

Check that it worked

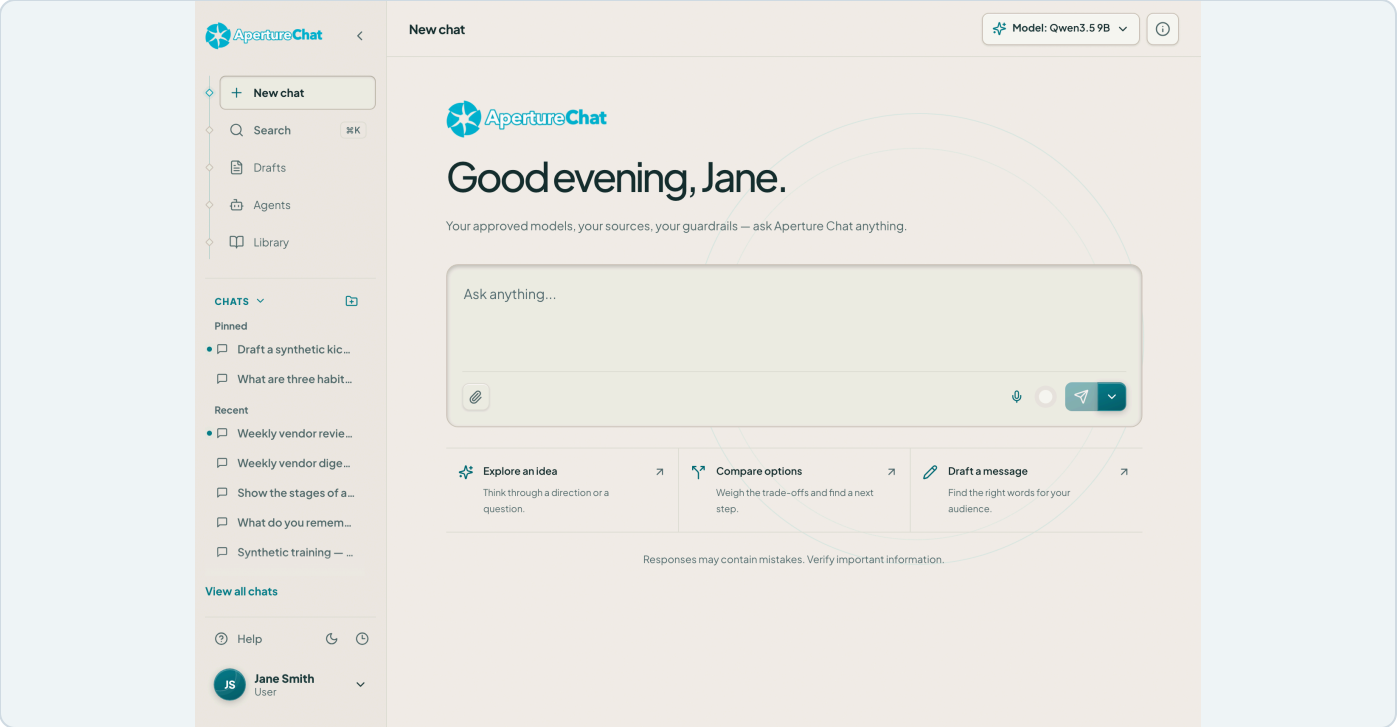
- ✓ Two-step verification shows On, with Your authenticator is connected. and the number of recovery codes that remain.
- ✓ Your next password sign-in asks for an **Authenticator code**.
- ✓ After signing in with a recovery code, the remaining count is one lower.
- ✓ After a password change, the **Password** card shows **Password** updated.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Current password is incorrect."	Retype your current password. If you have forgotten it, ask your administrator for a temporary password.
"The MFA code is invalid."	Wait for the next code and type it promptly. Codes depend on the time, so set your phone's clock to update automatically. A code that was already used is refused.
"Change the temporary password before enrolling MFA."	Sign in and choose your own password first, then set up the authenticator.
"Finish verification or save your recovery codes before leaving this panel."	Complete **Verify authenticator**, or copy and store the recovery codes and choose **Done**, before closing the panel.
"Required by your organization. You cannot turn this off."	Your organization requires two-step verification, so **Turn off verification** is not offered. To move to a new phone, ask your administrator to reset it.
"Your organization manages sign-in. Use your identity provider's security settings…"	You sign in with Organization **SSO**. Change your password and multifactor settings at your identity provider.
"Use a password with at least 12 characters." or "The new passwords do not match."	Use 12 or more characters and type the same new password in both fields.
"Password changes are only available for local password accounts."	Your account signs in with Organization **SSO**. Change the password at your identity provider.

5. Finding your way around

The sidebar, the main area, and what each navigation button opens.



The chat workspace: navigation on the left, model selection above, and the message composer in the main area. Example workspace with synthetic data.

The screen has two areas: a sidebar on the left and the main work area on the right. The sidebar is how you move between the platform's views and your saved chats.

Your first visit

The Getting started card explains what is ready for your account and what comes next. Open quick-start guide opens user help. Administrators see Open admin guide and Manage access. Follow the setup action offered for your role when no model is available. A missing model is an access or setup task, not a successful chat connection.

Choose a guide, take the suggested action, or select I'll explore on my own (or Dismiss welcome) when you are ready. Simply loading the page does not dismiss this card. You can return to guides from **Help** or console **Documentation** later.

SIDEBAR BUTTON	WHAT IT OPENS
New chat	A fresh conversation with your workspace assistant. This is the default view.
Search	**Search past work** for chats (including archived), documents and decks, agents, and indexed documents, plus commands. Shortcut: Ctrl+K (Windows) or ⌘K (Mac).
Drafts	A document and slide-deck editor with an AI assistant beside it.
Agents	Reusable agent profiles, plus an Automations tab for scheduled runs.
Library	Two tabs: **Knowledge** (searchable document collections) and **Tools** (connections, prompts, and skills).

Below the navigation buttons, your chat history is always listed under a small CHATS heading — folders first, then pinned chats, then recent chats. The next section covers organizing them.

Resizing and collapsing the sidebar

- Click the small chevron (‹) near the top of the sidebar to collapse it and give your work more room. Click the chevron again (›) to bring it back.
- Drag the sidebar's right edge to make it wider or narrower. Double-click that edge to collapse it.
- On a narrow window or a phone, the sidebar hides behind a menu button (three stacked lines, ≡) in the top-left corner. Tap it to open the menu; tap the dimmed area to close it.

Using the keyboard

Use Tab and Shift+Tab to move between controls and Enter or Space to activate the focused control. In a dialog, keyboard focus stays with that dialog. Use its Close or **Cancel** button, or Escape when available, to return to the control that opened it. Confirmations explain when an action is permanent before you commit it.

The bottom of the sidebar

- **Admin console** and Platform console — links shown only to administrators and platform owners (see “Where the consoles live”). Platform owners may also see a Release available notice here.
- **Help** — opens the guided walkthrough videos and this downloadable guide.
- **Dark mode / Light mode** and **Theme schedule** — two small buttons beside **Help**: the moon or sun switches the appearance instantly, and the clock sets a schedule (see “Light and dark mode” later in this guide).
- **Install app** — appears on phones and tablets, and adds the workspace to your home screen (see “Install the app on your phone”).
- Your account card — your initials or photo, name, and role. Click it to open the account drawer, including Personalization memory when your organization has enabled it.

Where the consoles live

Administrators choose **Admin console** near the bottom of the sidebar; platform owners also see Platform console. The account drawer's **Management** section lists the same consoles. Regular users see neither. The account drawer also holds **View as** role previews, **Usage this month**, and your **Archived chats** — all covered in “Your account”.

Returning to a view

The browser address follows the workspace view and console tab. Browser Back and Forward return to those views; opening a saved chat or draft link still checks your account's access. A link does not share private content or grant permission to another person.

6. Organizing chats: folders, pins, and the chat menu

Keep the chats you care about easy to find.

Your chat history is always visible under the CHATS heading: folders first, then a **Pinned** group when something is pinned, then your recent chats (labeled **Recent** only when a group sits above them). Click the CHATS heading to hide or show the whole list; this is remembered for your account on this device. While hidden, it shows a count and a dot for unread replies, and **Search** still finds every chat.

Folders

- Click the folder icon with a plus sign next to the CHATS heading.
- Type a name for the folder — a client, a matter, a project — and click **Create**.
- To file a chat into a folder, hover or focus its row, click the ⋯ (**More** actions) button, and choose Move to folder. Pick a folder, choose New folder to create one right there, or choose Remove from folder to take it out.
- Click a folder to expand or collapse the chats inside it.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> Deleting a folder does not delete its chats — they move back to the **Recent** list.

Pinned chats

- Hover or focus any chat row, click ⋯ (**More** actions), and choose Pin chat.
- The chat moves to the **Pinned** group, just below your folders, where it stays until you choose Unpin chat from the same menu.

Recent chats

- **Recent** chats — below folders and pinned chats — list your latest conversations. Click one to reopen it exactly where you left off.

- Hover or focus a row to reveal its ⋯ (**More** actions) button. The menu offers Pin chat (or Unpin chat), Move to folder, and **Archive**.
- A dot beside a chat marks a newest assistant reply you have not opened. Read status is saved to your account, so it matches in every browser and device.
- Archiving moves a chat out of the sidebar without deleting it — use it to tidy up. **Archived chats** are listed in your account drawer, where you can restore or permanently delete them.
- Click **View all chats** at the bottom of the list to browse your full history, including everything that no longer fits in the sidebar.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:36 · HELP › LEARN

Organize and find your work

Create folders and file chats in them, pin, archive and restore, rename chats, and hide your chat list.

Before you begin

- A few chats in your sidebar.
- **Folders** are kept in this browser: they do not follow you to another browser or device.

Step by step

1. Choose **Create** chat folder (the folder button beside CHATS), type a Folder name, and choose **Create**.
2. Point at a chat, choose its **More** actions button (…), then Move to folder, and choose the folder.
3. Check that the chat now sits inside the folder, with the folder's count updated.
4. To keep a chat at the top, choose … › Pin chat. It moves to **Pinned**.
5. To put a chat away, choose … › **Archive**. Find it later in your account card › **Archived chats** › View, and choose **Restore**.
6. To rename the open chat, choose Rename chat (the pencil beside its title), type the name, and choose Save chat name.
7. Choose the CHATS heading to hide your chat list; choose it again to show it.

Path: Folders

1. **Folders** can hold subfolders, up to four levels: choose **Create** subfolder in … on a folder.
2. … › Move to folder › Remove from folder takes a chat out again.
3. **Delete** … folder asks first; chats in it stay in **Recent**.

Path: Archive and delete

1. **Archive** keeps the chat and removes it from the sidebar (and unpins it).

2. **Account** card › **Archived chats** › View lists archived chats, with **Restore** and Permanently delete.
3. Permanently delete asks first and cannot be undone.

Path: Rename with AI

1. After the first reply, choose Rename chat with AI beside the title for a suggested name.

Path: See everything

1. **View all chats** opens All chats, with Filter chats to search titles.
2. View all pinned and View all folders appear when you have more than three.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The folder shows the filed chat and its count.
- ✓ The pinned chat appears under **Pinned**.
- ✓ An archived chat is listed under **Archived chats** until you restore it.
- ✓ With the list hidden, CHATS shows how many chats are tucked away.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
My folders are missing in another browser	**Folders** are stored in the browser where you made them. **Create** them again there; the chats themselves are in your account.
"Chat title cannot be blank."	Type a name before choosing Save chat name, or choose **Cancel** renaming chat.
"The AI could not rename this chat. Try again."	**Try again**, or type a name yourself with Rename chat.
A chat disappeared from the sidebar	It may be archived (account card › **Archived chats**), inside a folder, or hidden with the CHATS heading. **Search** finds it either way.
A chat left its folder after you renamed it	Renaming a chat currently takes it out of its folder. Choose … › Move to folder and pick the folder again.

WALKTHROUGH · 0:34 · HELP › LEARN

Preview chats at a glance

Hover any listed chat to read its prompts and outputs in a compact, scrollable preview.

Before you begin

- **Chats** in your sidebar, in All chats, or in **Archived chats**.

Step by step

1. Point at a chat name in the sidebar and wait a moment; keyboard users can focus the chat row instead.
2. Read the **Chat** preview: the title and time, then Prompt 1 and Output 1, in order.
3. Scroll inside the preview to read later prompts and outputs. The footer counts prompts and outputs.
4. Move away, or press Escape, to close it without opening the chat.
5. Choose the chat if you want to open it.

Path: In All chats

1. Choose **View all chats** under your recent chats.
2. Point at any chat in All chats; the preview opens beside the list.
3. Filter chats narrows the list by title first.

Path: In Archived chats

1. **Account** card › **Archived chats** › View.
2. Point at an archived chat to preview it before you restore or delete it.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The preview shows **Chat** preview, the chat's title, and Prompt 1.
- ✓ The footer counts the prompts and outputs.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"This chat does not have previewable content yet."	The chat has no messages yet.
No preview appears	Rest the pointer on the chat name for a moment, or focus the row with the keyboard.

7. Searching everything

Find saved work, preview a result, or run an available command.

- Click **Search** near the top of the sidebar, just below **New chat**, or press Ctrl+K (Windows) or ⌘K (Mac) from anywhere.

- The **Search past work** box opens. Type a few words from what you remember: a chat title, message text, an agent or draft name, slide text, or text from an indexed document.
- Results are grouped by kind. **Chat** results lead, matching text is highlighted, and archived conversations are labeled explicitly. Saved documents and decks open in their matching editor.
- Hover over or keyboard-focus a supported chat or draft result to preview it. The chat row also offers folder, pin, and archive or restore actions when that conversation is available in the current workspace.
- Click a result to open it, or use Up and Down followed by Enter. Escape closes search. Recently opened results are available when the query is empty.

Commands and saved work

Commands appear in a separate section from search results. Type > at the start of this search box to see all commands available to your role and permissions, then keep typing to narrow them. **Commands** can open workspace views and permitted actions; an unavailable feature does not become accessible through search. The same > symbol inside a chat message has a different purpose: choosing an automation for that message.

GOOD TO KNOW

Search includes only work your account can access. If the panel says Indexing your workspace, results may be incomplete until indexing finishes; try again after it completes. A missing result is not proof the work was deleted. Unsaved device-only changes may need saving to your account before server search can find them.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:20 · HELP › LEARN

Search, commands, and workspace links

Search every chat, draft, agent, and document you can access, reopen recent results, and run commands from the keyboard.

Before you begin

- Some saved work to find. **Archived chats** are included.

Step by step

1. Choose **Search** in the sidebar, or press Ctrl+K (⌘K on a Mac).
2. Type words from a title or a message.
3. Read the results, grouped by kind: Previous chats, Documents & knowledge, **Agents**, Automations, **Drafts**, and more.
4. Use the arrow keys and Enter, or choose a result, to open it.
5. Press Ctrl+K again. With an empty box, **Recent** lists what you opened from **Search**.
6. Type > to list commands, add a word to narrow them (for example >dark), and press Enter to run one.

Path: Act on a chat from Search

1. Point at a chat result for its buttons: add to a folder, pin, and archive or restore.
2. **Archived chats** are marked **Archived** conversation and can be restored from here.

Path: Commands

1. **New chat**; Go to **Chat**, **Drafts**, **Agents**, Automations, **Knowledge**, or **Tools**.
2. Switch to dark mode or Switch to light mode; Open **Help**; **Sign out**.
3. **Install app** appears on phones and tablets.

Path: Workspace links

1. Each screen has its own address (for example /drafts or /chat/ followed by the chat's id).
2. Browser Back and Forward move between the screens you visited.
3. A link never shares private content: whoever opens it must sign in and have access.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Results list the matching chats and other work.
- ✓ Choosing a result opens it.
- ✓ A command such as >dark changes the workspace at once.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Indexing your workspace… results may be incomplete until it finishes."	**Search** is still catching up. **Try again** in a moment.
"No chats or workspace items found for …"	Try fewer or different words, such as a word from the reply rather than the title.
"No commands match …"	Type > alone to see every command.
"Search failed."	Check your connection and search again.

PART 2

Chat

8. Your first chat

Send a message, pick a model, and control web search.

- Click **New chat** in the sidebar. A fresh chat greets you by the time of day — “Good morning”, “Good afternoon”, or “Good evening” with your first name (late at night it asks if you are burning the midnight oil) — above the tagline “Your approved models, your sources, your guardrails — ask Aperture Chat anything.” (The name reflects your organization's branding.)
- Click into the message box (the composer) — it reads **Ask anything…** — and type your question.
- Explore an idea, Compare options, and **Draft** a message offer starting points. Selecting one fills an editable prompt; review it before sending.
- Press Enter to send. Press **Shift+Enter** when you want a new line without sending.

Picking the model

The model selector sits in the top bar of every chat. Click it to choose which AI model answers this conversation. Each chat remembers its own choice, and the list only ever shows models your workspace has approved for you.

Use the arrow keys, Home, End, or type a model name to move through available models; Enter selects the highlighted model. Each row has its own star: Set [model name] as default model selects that model and remembers it for new chats. The filled star marks the single current default. Selecting a row without its star changes this conversation's model without changing the default. **Drafts** has a separate default drafting model, set with the star beside a row in its own selector.

Web search and the active-tools chip

- When the selected model supports it, public web search starts turned on. A chip at the bottom of the composer shows what is active: with one tool on it names it — for example **Web search** — and with several on it reads **Tools** with a count.
- Click the small × on that chip to clear the next message's active tools: **Knowledge**, **Web**, and **Agent**, selected MCP connections, and queued automations. Every new chat starts with web search on again when the model supports it.
- Replies that used the web come back with citations you can click, and every source is listed in the session details panel (covered below).

Sending

- The paper-plane button sends your message with the current settings.

- The chevron (˅) beside it opens send options — per-reply switches for **Knowledge**, **Web**, and **Agent**, plus the **Reasoning** level (covered in their own section).

Dictate instead of typing

- Click the microphone button in the send controls at the bottom-right of the composer to start dictating. A live waveform shows that the platform is hearing you.
- Click the button again — it becomes a stop square — and your words are transcribed and inserted into the composer as editable text. Nothing sends until you press Enter.
- If the microphone is blocked or no speech was heard, the composer says so plainly so you can fix the problem and try again. The **Drafts** workspace has the same dictation button for drafting instructions.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:38 · HELP › LEARN

Start chatting

Send your first message, watch it work, stop a reply, edit and resend your prompt, and copy the answer.

Before you begin

- A signed-in account with at least one available model. If the composer says Connect a model provider to start chatting..., see Choose models and request access.

Step by step

1. Choose **New chat** at the top of the sidebar.
2. Check the model selector at the top right (**Model**: and a name). Choose another model there if you need one.
3. Type your request where it says **Ask anything…**, or choose a starter such as Explore an idea. A starter only fills in the opening words.
4. Press Enter, or choose the paper-plane Send message button, to send. **Shift+Enter** adds a new line instead.
5. Watch Aperture Chat is working while the reply is prepared; the answer appears under it.
6. Read the reply. The work trace above it reads complete, and the chat is listed under **Recent** with a title from your request.
7. To keep the answer, choose **Copy** response text under the reply and wait for Copied.

Path: Stop a reply

1. While Aperture Chat is working, choose · stop at the top right of the trace.
2. The reply stops and keeps any text already written, with You stopped this response before it finished.
3. To ask again, use Edit and resend.

Path: Edit and resend

1. Point at your message and choose **Edit message** (the pencil).
2. Change the text. Escape cancels.
3. Choose Send edited message. Everything after that message is removed, and the model answers the new text.

Path: Regenerate

1. On a finished reply, choose **Regenerate response** (the circular arrows).
2. The model answers the same request again.
3. A stopped or failed reply has no actions; use Edit and resend instead.

Path: Reuse a prompt in a new chat

1. Point at your message and choose **Load prompt in new chat** (the paper plane beside the pencil).
2. A new chat opens with your prompt and its attachments in the message box, ready to send.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Your message and the model's reply both appear, and the trace above the reply reads complete.
- ✓ The chat is listed under **Recent** in the sidebar.
- ✓ Copied appears beside the reply's actions after you copy it.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The message box says "Connect a model provider to start chatting…"	No model is available to your account. Open the model selector or **Why isn't a model listed?**, and request access.
"You stopped this response before it finished. Regenerate or resend the message to run it again."	A stopped reply has no Regenerate button. Choose **Edit message** on your prompt, then Send edited message.
A reply reads "… did not return a completion: …"	The model service failed. Resend with **Edit message**. If it repeats, tell your administrator. Some self-hosted models reject Regenerate with "System message must be at the beginning."; resend instead.
The pencil says "Wait for the current response to finish before editing"	Wait for the reply, or choose · stop first.
"The edited message could not be sent. Check the text and try again."	Make sure the edited text is not empty, then choose Send edited message again.
"Copy unavailable"	The browser blocked the clipboard. Select the reply text and copy it with the keyboard instead.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:46 · HELP › LEARN

Dictation, images, and diagrams

Dictate a message when your workspace has a transcription model, ask an image model for pictures, and copy, view, and download diagrams.

Before you begin

- For dictation: a microphone, permission for this site to use it, and a transcription model (a Gemini Flash model) set up by your platform owner.
- For images: an image-generation model available to you in the model selector.
- For diagrams: any available model. Ask for a diagram, flowchart, or process. Mermaid, Graphviz, PlantUML, arrow chains, numbered step or layer lists, and box drawings all render as figures.

Step by step

1. In the message box, choose Dictate a message (the microphone).
2. Allow microphone access if the browser asks.
3. Speak. A live waveform shows it is recording; recording stops by itself after 2 minutes.

4. Choose Stop dictation and transcribe (the square). The transcript is added to the message box as editable text.
5. Review the text, then send it yourself; dictation never sends on its own.

Path: Images

1. In the model selector, choose a model that can generate images.
2. Describe the picture you want; ask for up to 4.
3. The images appear in the reply, labeled Generated image.
4. Point at an image and choose **Download** to save it. **Download** links last 7 days.

Path: Diagrams

1. Ask for a diagram, for example: show the stages of a process as a flowchart.
2. The reply shows a figure in the workspace's colors, with **Copy**, **PNG**, **SVG**, **Code**, and Edit in its header. Mermaid, Graphviz (DOT), PlantUML, arrow chains (A → B → C), numbered step or layer lists, and box drawings are all drawn as figures.
3. **Notes** the model wrote alongside a text drawing appear under the figure.
4. Choose **Code** to read the source exactly as the model wrote it; choose Diagram to switch back. **Copy** copies that source.
5. Choose **PNG** or **SVG** to download the picture.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Dictation: the transcript appears in the message box, ready to edit.
- ✓ Images: **Download** saves the image as a file.
- ✓ Diagrams: the figure renders in the reply, and **PNG** downloads it as a picture file.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"No configured Gemini Flash model is available for dictation. …"	Your workspace has no transcription model. Type your message, and ask your platform owner to set one up.
"Microphone access was denied. Allow microphone use for this site to dictate."	Allow the microphone in your browser's site settings, then try again.
"Microphone capture is not available in this browser."	Use a current browser on a device with a microphone.
"No audio was captured. Check the selected microphone and try again." or "The dictation model heard no speech in the recording."	Check which microphone your device uses and speak closer to it.
"… returned no images for this request. Try rephrasing the prompt or selecting a different image model."	Rephrase the request, or choose another image model.
"This diagram could not be rendered. Open Code to inspect the source, or Edit to fix it."	The model's diagram source has an error. Open **Code** to see it, then ask the model to correct the diagram, or choose Edit to fix it yourself.

9. Understand model availability and request access

Read the server's reason, ask for a model when permitted, and follow its request status.

- Open the chat model selector and choose **Why isn't a model listed?** If no model is usable, the No models available control opens the same explanation.
- **Models in your organization** separates **Usable now** from **Not available to you**. Read the reason on the model row: **Locked** describes an access restriction; **Provider offline** means you already have access but the provider needs attention.
- Choose **Request access** only where it is enabled. The request goes to an administrator for review; sending it does not grant immediate access.
- While a request is pending, the row shows its date and **Withdraw request**. Use **Refresh model access** after your administrator resolves it, then select the usable model in the chat picker.

GOOD TO KNOW

Your organization may show only models you can already use. Its browsing policy controls whether you can inspect other enabled models and request access. Some restrictions cannot be lifted by a request; ask your administrator about the stated reason. An offline provider needs a platform-owner repair, not another group-access request.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:58 · HELP › LEARN

Choose models and request access

Pick the model for a chat, star your default, find out why a model is missing, and request, withdraw, and use a model your administrator approves.

Before you begin

- A signed-in account with at least one model available. If the selector reads No models available, start at **Why isn't a model listed?**.
- Your organization must allow access requests. If it shows only models you can already use, ask your administrator about others.
- An administrator to review requests. Approval happens in their **Admin console** › **Model Access**.

Step by step

1. In a chat, open the model selector (**Model**: and the model's name) at the top right.
2. Choose a model to use it in this chat. Each chat keeps its own model.
3. Choose the star beside a model to make it your default for new chats in this browser.
4. Choose **Why isn't a model listed?** at the bottom of the selector. **Models in your organization** lists **Usable now** and **Not available to you**, with the server's reason for each.
5. Beside a **Locked** model, choose **Request access**. The row changes to Request pending since and the date.
6. Wait for your administrator to approve. Approval adds you to a group that carries the model and signs you out of your current sessions.
7. Sign in again. The model is listed under **Usable now** and in the selector. Choose it and send a message.

Path: Withdraw a request

1. Open the model selector › **Why isn't a model listed?**.
2. Beside the pending model, choose **Withdraw request**.
3. Withdrew the request for the model appears, and **Request access** is offered again.

Path: Provider offline

1. A **Provider offline** badge means the connection behind the model is not working.
2. Requesting access does not fix a disconnected provider; the platform owner must reconnect it.
3. Choose **Refresh model access** later, or use another model in the meantime.

Path: After approval

1. If the dialog or a chat says Session is invalid or expired. Sign in again., sign in again.
2. Open the selector: the new model is listed. Choose it for this chat, or star it to make it your default.
3. Send a message; the reply comes from the newly granted model.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The selector shows **Model**: and your chosen model's name, and the reply comes from that model.
- ✓ The starred model is filled in, and new chats start with it.
- ✓ After approval and a fresh sign-in, the model is listed under **Usable now** with Available.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Not granted to any of your groups. An administrator can add you to a group that has this model."	Choose **Request access**, or ask your administrator to add you to a group that has the model.
"The provider behind this model is not connected right now." (Provider offline)	A request cannot fix this. The platform owner must reconnect the provider. Use another model meanwhile.
"Disabled by the platform owner for the whole organization."	The model is switched off for everyone. Ask your administrator whether it will be enabled.
"Session is invalid or expired. Sign in again." right after a request	Your administrator approved the request, which signs you out. Sign in again; the model is then listed.
"Model access requests are disabled by organization policy."	Your organization does not take requests here. Contact your administrator directly.
"Too many access requests. Try again shortly."	Wait a minute. A pending request stays pending; you do not need to resend it.
The selector reads No models available	No model is usable for your account yet. Choose it to open **Models in your organization**, request access, or contact your administrator.

10. Reading and acting on replies

The work trace, citations, and the actions under every message.

The work trace

- While a reply is being produced, a single status line shows the current step, a live timer, and how many steps remain (for example “4s · step 2 of 5”).
- Click that line at any time — while running or after — to expand the full trace: which model was routed, what context was prepared, whether web search ran, and how the answer was finalized.
- While a reply is still streaming, a stop button appears — its label is **Stop this response**. Clicking it halts the reply and keeps the conversation.

Actions under each response

- **Copy** — copies the response as clean, readable text.
- Thumbs up / thumbs down — sends feedback your administrators can review.
- **Branch** — starts a new chat that continues from that response, leaving the original untouched.
- **Regenerate response** — asks the model to answer the same prompt again. Version arrows appear on the response with a counter (for example “2 / 3”) so you can flip between the versions it has produced.
- **Transfer to Drafts** — turns the response into an editable document in the **Drafts** workspace, where you can format, version, and export it.

Actions under your own messages

- **Edit message** — reopens your prompt for editing. Sending the edit removes the later replies and asks again from that point.
- **Load prompt in new chat** — copies the prompt and its attachments into a fresh chat's composer, ready to adjust and resend.

Diagrams in replies

When a reply contains a diagram (a flowchart, sequence, or similar), it renders as a real figure, not a code block. The figure's toolbar offers **Copy** for the diagram source, **PNG** and **SVG** to download it as an image file, and **Code** to flip between the drawing and its source text.

Generated images

- When the selected model can generate images, just ask for one — the finished images appear directly in the reply.
- Click **Download** under an image to save it as a file.

Citations and token usage

- When a reply used the web or your knowledge bases, numbered citations appear with it. Click a citation to open the original source.
- A small token count appears under a reply only when the model provider actually reported one — the platform never shows an estimate dressed up as a real number.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:43 · HELP › LEARN

Follow the work trace and act on replies

Read the steps behind a reply, rate it with a note, branch it into a new chat, and turn it into an editable document.

Before you begin

- A chat with at least one finished reply (see Start chatting).

Step by step

1. Under a finished reply's heading, find Work trace and its summary, such as complete · 4 steps.
2. Choose Work trace to expand it and read every step: Routing request names the model, Preparing context lists the sources, then Generating answer and Finalizing response.
3. Choose Work trace again to collapse it.
4. Choose Send positive feedback (thumbs up) or Send negative feedback (thumbs down) under the reply.
5. Optionally type a note in the box that opens, then choose Send note. Note sent confirms it.
6. Choose **Branch** response into new chat to continue from this reply in a separate chat.
7. Choose **Transfer to Drafts** to open the reply as an editable document.

Path: Rate a reply

1. Choose the thumbs up or thumbs down under the reply. Positive feedback sent (or Negative feedback sent) appears.
2. In What worked well? or What went wrong?, add an optional note of up to 2,000 characters.
3. Choose Send note, or close the box to skip the note.

Path: Branch into a new chat

1. Choose **Branch** response into new chat under the reply.
2. A new chat opens, titled **Branch**: and the original title, holding the prompt and this reply.
3. Continue there; the original chat is unchanged.

Path: Transfer to Drafts

1. Choose **Transfer to Drafts** at the right of the reply's actions.
2. **Drafts** opens a new document titled after the chat, saved as Version 1, with the reply and any citations.
3. Edit it, save versions, and export it (see **Draft** documents).

Check that it worked

- ✓ The expanded trace lists the model used in Routing request.
- ✓ Note sent appears beside the reply's actions after sending a note.
- ✓ A chat titled **Branch**: … appears under **Recent**.
- ✓ **Drafts** opens with the reply as a saved document, and the assistant rail says it was transferred.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The running trace moves to the next step before that step seems done	While a reply runs, the trace advances through the planned steps on a timer. Treat it as a guide to what the request involves; the finished trace is the record.
"Could not branch"	The branch could not be created, often because the connection dropped. **Try again** when the chat has saved.
No actions under a reply	Actions appear only on finished replies. A stopped or failed reply has none; resend with **Edit message**.
Transfer to Drafts is missing	It appears on finished replies with text. Wait for the reply to finish.

11. Symbol shortcuts: / @ # $ >

Five characters that pull prompts, agents, knowledge, skill files, and automations into a message.

Start a word in the message box with one of five symbols and a menu opens with matching items. You can also choose **Send options** → **Resources** to browse without memorizing a symbol. Forgot one? The bottom of Session details (ⓘ) lists all five, and **Help** → Symbol shortcuts: / @ # $ > shows each menu in action.

TYPE	WHAT IT OPENS
/	Saved prompts (inserted as text) and enabled MCP connections (turned on for this message).
@	**Agent** profiles — the reply routes through the one you pick.
#	**Knowledge** bases and the files inside them. Picking one turns on **Knowledge** for that source.
$	Saved skill files. The one you pick is attached to the message.
>	Automations, including paused ones. The one you pick runs on your message when you send.

- Type the symbol, then keep typing to filter the list.
- Use the ↑ and ↓ arrow keys to move through the menu.
- Press Enter to insert the highlighted item, Tab to complete it, or Escape to dismiss the menu.

Browse resources

On the **Resources** tab, use **Find a resource** to search by name, or select All, **Knowledge** bases, Files in knowledge sources, MCP connections, **Prompts**, **Agents**, Skill files, or Automations. A selected connection or automation shows a check; choose it again to remove it. Read an empty or failed-loading state before retrying. The **Type shortcuts in chat** reference explains each symbol below the results.

TIP

The expanded composer focuses on editing a longer message. Return to the normal composer to browse resources, adjust send options, and send with the visible controls.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:49 · HELP › LEARN

Symbol shortcuts: / @ # $ >

Type a symbol in the message box to add a saved prompt, an agent, knowledge, a skill file, or an automation, then send.

Before you begin

- A chat with an available model.
- Items to choose from: saved prompts and skill files are shared by your administrators; agents, knowledge bases, and automations are ones you can use or have built.

Step by step

1. Click in the message box. At the start of a word, type one of the five symbols: / @ # $ or >.
2. A list opens above the message box. Keep typing to narrow it.
3. Use the up and down arrow keys to move, and Enter (or a click) to choose. Escape closes the list.

4. Check what was added: prompt text in the box, or a chip under it (**Agent**, **Knowledge**, a skill file, or an automation).
5. Finish your message and send it.

Path: / Prompts and MCP connections

1. Type / to list saved prompts and enabled MCP connections.
2. Choose a prompt to put its text in the message box; edit it before sending.
3. Choose a connection to turn it on for this message.

Path: @ Agents

1. Type @ to list the agent profiles you can use.
2. Choose one. @ and its name are added, and the **Agent** chip appears.
3. The reply runs through that agent's model, instructions, knowledge, and tools.

Path: # Knowledge

1. Type # to list knowledge bases and the files in them.
2. Choose a knowledge base, or a single file to search its source.
3. The **Knowledge** chip appears; the reply searches it and cites what it uses.

Path: $ Skill files

1. Type $ to list saved skill files, such as citation rules or an approval checklist.
2. Choose one. It is attached to the message as a file chip (Name.md).
3. The model follows it for this message.

Path: > Automations

1. Type > to list your automations, including paused ones.
2. Choose one. It is queued in the chip under the message box.
3. When you send, the automation runs on your message. × removes it before sending.

Check that it worked

- ✓ After choosing, the message box holds the prompt text or shows the matching chip.
- ✓ A message sent with # and $ returns a reply that lists its sources and View N citations →.
- ✓ Session details › Symbol shortcuts lists all five symbols at any time.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"No matching commands. Try another name."	Nothing matches what you typed after the symbol. **Delete** some letters, or check the item's name.
"No saved prompts or enabled MCP connections yet — add them under Tools"	Nothing is shared with you yet. Your administrator adds prompts and connections.
"No agent profiles available yet — create one under Agents"	Build an agent (if your account can) or ask your administrator to share one.
"No knowledge bases are enabled yet — add one under Knowledge"	Ask your administrator to share a knowledge base, or create one if your account can.
"Some files could not be loaded. Retry"	Choose Retry in the list. Sources that already loaded stay usable.
The list does not open	The symbol must start a word: type a space first if it follows other text.

12. Attaching files, web pages, and connected sources

Upload from your computer, fetch a page by link, or pull from your organization's drives.

- Click the paperclip button at the bottom-left of the composer.
- Click **Upload from computer** to attach files from this device. The model reads them as context for your next message.
- Or click **Web page by link** and paste one or more web addresses — the platform fetches up to 3 public pages and attaches them as cited sources for this message.
- Attached items appear as chips above the composer. Click the × on a chip to remove one before sending.

Attach from source

Below those options, under the **Attach from source** heading, the menu lists your organization's workspace sources: Google Drive, OneDrive, SharePoint, Box, and iManage. Which ones appear depends on your administrator: a source that is switched off or hidden in **Admin console** → **Connections** does not appear in the menu, and its files cannot be attached.

Connecting your own account

- Cloud sources read from your own account. The first time you pick one, the picker may ask you to connect it — click the Connect button for that source and a sign-in window opens.

- **Approve** read access in that window. The file list refreshes on its own once access is granted, and only you can see files from your account.
- The picker shows files at the top level of the drive or the folder configured for the source, within your account's permissions.

GOOD TO KNOW

If a source you expect is missing or needs configuration, ask your administrator: workspace connectors are set up, tested, and hidden or shown in **Admin console** → **Connections**. Your own Connect action in the attach menu remains separate and grants access only through your source account.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:08 · HELP › LEARN

Attach files and sources

Attach a file from your computer, a web page by link, or a file from a connected cloud source, and know what the model actually receives.

Before you begin

- A chat with an available model.
- For cloud sources (Google Drive, OneDrive, SharePoint, Box, iManage): your administrator must set up the connector, and you sign in to your own account the first time.
- Files up to 25 MB each. **Web** pages must be public addresses starting with http:// or https://.

Step by step

1. In the message box, choose Add attachment (the paperclip).
2. Choose **Upload from computer** and pick one or more files.
3. Wait for the file chip to finish uploading. Remove a file with the × on its chip.
4. Type your question about the file and send it.
5. Check the reply: it uses the file's content, and the trace includes a step for reading attachments.

Path: Web page by link

1. Paperclip › **Web page by link**.
2. Type or paste the full address into **Web** page address, such as https://example.com, and choose Add link (or press Enter).
3. The link appears as a chip. Add up to 3 links per message.
4. Send your question. The page is fetched when you send and cited in the reply (View 1 citation →).

Path: Cloud sources

1. Paperclip › choose a source under **Attach from source**: Google Drive, OneDrive, SharePoint, Box, or iManage.
2. The first time, choose Connect and approve read access in the sign-in window. Only you see files from your account.
3. Tick up to 10 files and choose Attach selected.
4. If the dialog says the source is not ready, your administrator must finish setting up that connector.

Path: What the model receives

1. Word (.docx) and text files (.txt, .md, .csv, .json, .xml, .html, .rtf, .eml, .log): the opening text, up to about 2,400 characters.
2. Images: the picture itself, if the selected model can read images; otherwise the model says it cannot see them.
3. Audio and video: a transcript, when your workspace has a transcription model. Media longer than 45 minutes is refused.
4. PDF, Excel, and PowerPoint files from your computer: currently only the file name. To ask about their content, add them to a knowledge base, attach them from a cloud source, or open a Word or PDF file in **Drafts** with Open in editor (in the **Drafts** paperclip menu).

Check that it worked

- ✓ The file chip finishes uploading without Upload failed.
- ✓ The reply states facts that appear only in your file or page.
- ✓ A web-page reply offers View 1 citation → for the attached page.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Attachment exceeds the 25 MB chat upload limit."	Split or compress the file, or add it to a knowledge base, which accepts larger files.
"Could not upload the attachment. Check your connection and try again."	Check your connection, remove the failed chip, and attach the file again.
The reply says it cannot see the content of a PDF, spreadsheet, or slide file	Files of those types uploaded from your computer currently reach the model by name only. Use a knowledge base or a cloud source instead, or open a Word or PDF file in **Drafts** with Open in editor.
"Enter a full web address starting with http:// or https://."	Paste the complete address, including https://.
"You can attach up to 3 web links per message."	Send the first three, then attach the rest in a follow-up message.
"Web source fetch failed for …"	The page could not be fetched (it may need a sign-in or be offline). **Copy** the text into your message instead.
"Google Drive is not ready." (or another source)	Your administrator has not finished that connector. Ask them, or upload the file from your computer.
A cloud source, such as Google Drive, is missing from the paperclip menu	Your workspace administrators hid it (**Admin console** › **Connections** › Hide). A hidden source is no longer offered in the attach menu, and the server refuses it with "Google Drive is not available in this workspace." Ask your administrator, or upload the file from your computer.
"Media longer than 45 minutes cannot be transcribed in this version."	Split the recording and upload the part you need.

13. Send options: Knowledge, Web, Agent, and Reasoning

Control what the model may use, one reply at a time.

- Click the chevron (˅) beside the paper-plane send button.
- The menu opens with **Send now** at the top — that simply sends with the current settings.
- Below it are three switches you can turn on or off for the next reply, and a **Reasoning** slider at the bottom.

SWITCH	WHAT IT DOES WHEN ON
Knowledge	The reply searches your enabled knowledge bases and cites what it finds, with links back to the sources. A picker lets you choose which bases to use.
Web	The reply uses public web search. Results come back as clickable citations, and the sources are listed in session details. Available when the selected model supports it.
Agent	The reply uses the selected agent profile and its permitted tools. Turning this on can choose the first available profile if none is selected; confirm the **Agent profile** field before sending, or choose a profile with @.

Reasoning level

The **Reasoning** group at the bottom of the menu is a three-position slider from **Fast** to **Smart**. **Fast** favors quicker answers; **Smart** makes the model think longer for more detailed output; the middle is a balanced default. The slider is only active when the selected model supports reasoning levels — otherwise it is disabled and says so.

Whenever tools are on, the active-tools chip appears next to the paperclip: the single tool's name, or **Tools** with a count. Click its × to turn off **Knowledge**, **Web**, and **Agent** and clear selected MCP connections and queued automations for the next message.

On the **Reply settings** tab, **Stream replies** controls whether text appears as the model produces it or only after the reply finishes. The **Resources** tab opens the searchable resource picker; **MCP connections and resources** also opens it from **Reply settings**. These controls change how the next reply is prepared or displayed; they do not supply missing provider or connector access.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:43 · HELP › LEARN

Knowledge, Web, Agent, and reply settings

Ground a reply in a knowledge base and check its citations, and choose Web, an agent, reasoning, streaming, and resources for a message.

Before you begin

- A chat with an available model.
- For **Knowledge**: at least one knowledge base shared with you (see **Knowledge** bases).
- For **Web**: your workspace must connect web search to the model you use. Otherwise **Web** is greyed out.
- For **Agent**: an agent profile you can use (see **Agent** profiles).

Step by step

1. In the message box, choose **Send options** (the arrow beside the paper plane). **Send options** opens on **Reply settings**.

2. Choose **Knowledge**, then choose the source to search, such as Litigation Playbook. Each source shows how many files it holds.
3. Choose Close send options. The **Knowledge** chip under the message box shows it is on.
4. Type your question and send it.
5. Check the reply: the work trace lists one more step, and View 2 citations → appears under the answer.
6. Choose View citations to open Session details › **Sources gathered**, with each source's K number, file name, and the passage used.

Path: Web

1. When your workspace connects web search to the model you use, **Web** is on in every new chat, and the chip under the message box reads **Web search**.
2. Send your message. Aperture Chat searches public web sources and gives the results, with their addresses, to the model so the reply can cite them.
3. To answer without the web, turn off **Web** in **Send options** (or choose × on the chip, which turns every option off). That lasts for this chat; the next new chat starts with **Web** on again.
4. If **Web** is greyed out, your workspace has not connected web search to this model. Ask your administrator.

Path: Agent

1. **Send options** › **Agent**. An **Agent profile** list appears under it.
2. Choose the profile you want; the line under it counts its knowledge, files, and tools.
3. Send your message. The trace reads **Agent** work trace. See **Agent** profiles to build your own.

Path: Reasoning and streaming

1. Under **Reasoning**, drag the slider toward **Fast** for quicker answers or **Smart** for deeper thinking, on models that support it.
2. Clear **Stream replies** to show each reply only when it is complete; leave it ticked to watch the answer arrive.

Path: Resources

1. **Send options** › **Resources** (or **MCP connections and resources**).
2. **Search** by name, or filter by **Knowledge** bases, Files in knowledge sources, MCP connections, **Prompts**, **Agents**, Skill files, or Automations.
3. Choose an item. A prompt's text fills the message box; other items turn on for this message.

Path: Turn everything off

1. Choose × on the chip under the message box.
2. **Knowledge**, **Web**, and **Agent** turn off, selected MCP connections clear, and queued automations are removed.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The chip under the message box names what is on (**Knowledge**, **Web search**, **Agent**, or **Tools** with a count).
- ✓ A knowledge reply shows View N citations →, and **Sources gathered** lists the files and passages.
- ✓ The reply's trace includes a step for each option you turned on.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Web is greyed out: "Web search is turned off for this model by your workspace configuration"	Your workspace has not connected web search to this model. Choose another model, or ask your administrator.
With Web on, the reply stays on Aperture Chat is working	Some self-hosted models currently reject web-search requests. Choose · stop, turn **Web** off, and resend; tell your administrator.
"Web search (…) is unavailable: … Turn off Web for this reply to continue without it."	The search service could not be reached. Turn **Web** off for this message, or try again later.
Knowledge cannot be chosen	No knowledge base is shared with you. Ask your administrator, or create one if your account can (see **Knowledge** bases).
"Create an agent profile in Agents to enable this mode."	No agent profile is available to you. Build one under **Agents**, or ask your administrator to share one.
An agent is listed as "(needs Hermes approval)" and cannot be chosen	It is a **Hermes** agent. Ask your administrator to turn on **Can use Hermes companion** for one of your groups.
"… does not support reasoning levels"	The selected model has no reasoning control. The slider has no effect for it.

14. Session details and sources

Real token usage, active tools, every source this chat gathered, and the symbol shortcuts.

- Click the round information button (ⓘ) at the right end of the chat's top bar.

- The session details panel opens for the current chat.
- **Current chat** and **Model** — the user-message and response counts, and which model is active.
- **Tokens used** — shown only when the model provider reported real numbers. Otherwise the panel says "Not reported by the provider".
- **Tools** — exactly what is switched on for your next message: web search, knowledge, agent mode, plus any automations or MCP connections you added in the composer. "Off" means nothing is active.
- **Sources gathered** — every web source (as clickable links) and workspace citation collected during this conversation.
- Symbol shortcuts — at the bottom of the panel, the five symbols you can type in the message box and what each one pulls in. See "Symbol shortcuts: / @ # $ >".

The **Context window** meter describes how much context this conversation uses. For older conversations without provider counts it can show ≈ and estimated from message length. Treat that as an estimate; **Tokens used** remains based on actual provider reports. When the context window fills, start a new chat and include the details it needs to continue reliably.

WALKTHROUGH · 0:59 · HELP › LEARN

Session details and context

Open Session details to check the model, tokens used, how full the context window is, the sources a reply used, and the symbol shortcuts.

Before you begin

- A chat with at least one reply. **Sources gathered** appears after a reply that used knowledge or the web.

Step by step

1. In a chat, choose Session info (the i button at the top right). Session details opens on the right.
2. Read Session summary: **Current chat**, **Tokens used**, **Model**, **Knowledge** bases, **Tools**, and **Agent profile**.
3. Read **Context window**: the meter and how many of the model's tokens this chat already uses.
4. Scroll to **Sources gathered** to see every source a reply used, with its K (knowledge) or W (web) number and the passage.
5. Scroll to Symbol shortcuts for the five symbols you can type in the message box.
6. Choose Close session details when you are done.

Path: From a reply's citations

1. Under a reply, choose View N citations →.

2 Session details opens at **Sources gathered** for that reply. Hide citations closes it again.

Check that it worked

- ✓ **Tokens used** shows the counts the provider reported (in, out, and total), or Not reported by the provider.
- ✓ The context window meter shows a percentage and tokens used of the model's total.
- ✓ **Sources gathered** lists the same number of sources as View N citations.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Tokens used reads "Not reported by the provider"	The model service did not return usage. Nothing is wrong with your chat; the context meter may use an estimate instead.
The context meter is marked estimated or ≈	It is based on message length, because the provider did not report usage for some messages.
The context window is nearly full	Start a new chat for a fresh window. Older details may otherwise matter less to the answer.
No Sources gathered section	The replies in this chat did not use knowledge or the web. Turn on **Knowledge** in **Send options** and ask again.

15. Personal data in your chats

Locked chips for concealed values, what the model receives, and how rated answers are kept.

Your organization can conceal personal data in chats. When it does, the line under the message box ends with Personal data is concealed. As soon as you send a message, values such as Social Security, card, and account numbers, email addresses, phone numbers, health identifiers, and passwords or keys are replaced with a locked chip such as SSN or Email. The original value is not saved anywhere in the workspace, so it cannot be recovered from the chat later.

YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
A locked chip in your message, such as SSN	The value was concealed before the chat was saved. Reopening the chat shows the chip, not the value.
[SSN] or [EMAIL] in a reply	Your organization keeps values from the model, so the model received a placeholder. Add the real value yourself in the system where it belongs, not in the chat.
A locked chip in a reply	Your organization lets the model read values for work that needs them. A value the model writes is concealed before you see it.
A note in the rating box about a de-identified copy	Your organization captures training examples from rated answers and notes. The copy is de-identified and never sent to a model provider.

GOOD TO KNOW

Concealment recognizes values by their format and check digits. It does not recognize names or free-text descriptions of someone's health, and it does not alter drafts or uploaded files. Follow your organization's policy for those.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:15 · HELP › LEARN

Personal data in your chats

Recognize the personal data your organization conceals, know what the model received, and see how rated answers are kept when your organization captures training examples.

Before you begin

- Your administrator has turned on **Personal Data Protection**. If not, none of this appears and chats are stored as typed.
- An available model.

Step by step

1. Look under the message box. When your organization protects personal data, the line ends with Personal data is concealed. Point at it for a short explanation.
2. Send your message as usual. Social Security, card, and account numbers, contact details, health identifiers, and secrets become locked chips, such as SSN or Email, as soon as the message is sent.
3. Read the reply. When your organization keeps values from the model, the model received placeholders only, so its draft shows them, for example [SSN], where a value belongs.
4. Add the real values yourself in the system where they belong, not in the chat.

5. When you rate a reply with the thumbs buttons, read the note box. If your organization captures training examples, it says so: a de-identified copy of rated answers and notes is kept and never sent to a model provider.

Path: Values kept from the model (shown)

1. Your sent message shows locked chips.
2. The model received placeholders instead of the values, so its reply refers to them, for example [SSN] or [EMAIL].

Path: Model allowed to read values (shown)

1. Your sent message still shows locked chips.
2. The model read the values for that turn, so it can use them, for example in a signature block.
3. Any value it writes is replaced with a locked chip before you see the reply and before the chat is saved.

Path: Rating answers when training capture is on (shown)

1. Choose thumbs up or thumbs down under a reply. The note box says your organization keeps a de-identified copy of rated answers and notes, and that it is never sent to a model provider.
2. Type a note and choose Send note, or close the box with ×. The rating counts either way.
3. Corrections you type in the chat, such as "That's wrong, the deadline is 60 days. Please revise.", can be kept the same way.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The line under the message box ends with Personal data is concealed.
- ✓ Your sent message shows a locked chip where you typed the value.
- ✓ Reopening the chat later still shows the chip, not the value.

Troubleshooting

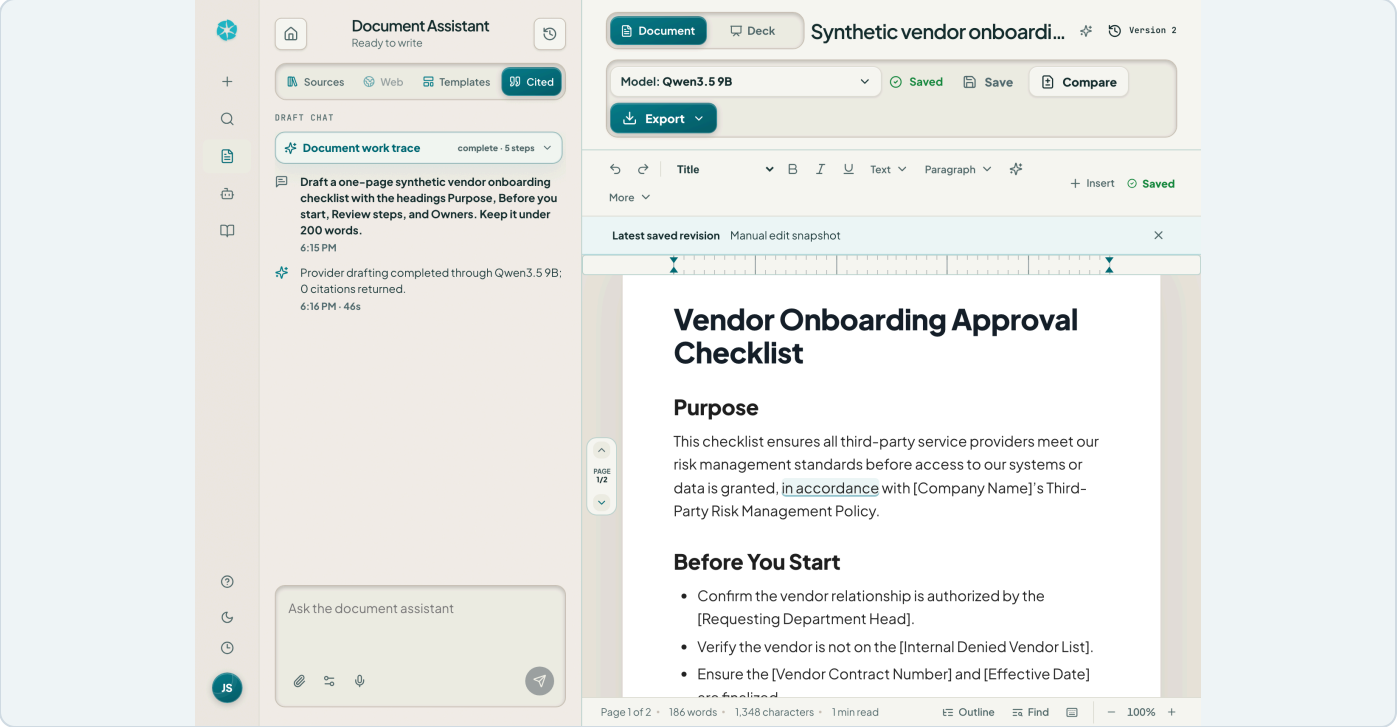
WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Your message shows the value for a moment after you send it	The concealed copy replaces it within a moment. The original value is not saved.
The reply says [SSN] or similar where you expected a value	The model never received the value. Fill it in yourself where it belongs; do not paste it back into the chat.
A name or a description of someone's health was not concealed	Concealment recognizes numbers, codes, and contact details by their format. It does not recognize names or free text about health, so leave them out when your policy requires it.
A draft still contains a value	**Drafts** are documents of record and are not altered. Keep personal data out of drafts unless your policy allows it.
You need the original value from an earlier chat	It was never saved, so the chat cannot give it back. Use the system of record it came from.

PART 3

Drafts, decks, and agents

16. Drafting documents

Generate, edit, version, and export documents with the drafting assistant.



Drafts combines the document editor with a separate assistant and document controls. Example workspace with synthetic data.

Click **Drafts** in the sidebar. The view pairs a full document editor with an AI assistant rail on the left that writes into the editor for you. A **Draft format** switch at the top of the editor has two buttons — **Document** and **Deck**. This section covers document mode; "Building a slide deck" covers deck mode.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> If the model selector says No models connected, AI drafting, AI rename, inline AI edits, and AI deck prompts are unavailable. You can still edit manually, import, save, use document history, and export. Follow the setup guidance for your role or ask your administrator for access to a working model.

Generating a draft

- Look at the Sources, **Web**, and Templates chips at the top of the assistant rail first: they show which context is on before you generate anything.

- In the assistant's message box, describe the document you need: a memo, an engagement letter, a summary. Be specific about audience and tone if it matters. The suggested requests under the heading fill the box for you.
- The assistant writes the document directly into the editor. You can also send any chat response here with **Transfer to Drafts**, or, when you ask for a document in chat, choose Write in **Drafts** on the card that appears (see "Hand a chat request to **Drafts**").
- Use the model selector in the toolbar area to choose which approved model writes and edits this draft.

Opening a file from this device

Click the paperclip in the assistant's message box. Under From this device are two choices. Attach to chat gives files to the assistant to read with your next request; they become sources, not the document. Open in editor opens one file as the document itself, so you can edit it directly or select text and use **Ask AI**.

- Open in editor accepts Word (.docx, .dotx, .doc), PDF (.pdf), **Markdown** (.md), plain text (.txt), and web page (.html) files. Word and PDF files keep their page setup, headers, footers, page numbers, tab stops, and tables; web pages keep their formatting; **Markdown** keeps its headings, lists, and emphasis. When something could not be carried over, an import note in the assistant rail says what. "Open a Word or PDF file and keep its formatting" walks through it.
- The file opens as a new draft and is saved to your account as one. The draft you had open stays in **Document history**; if it has unsaved changes, the unsaved-changes dialog asks first.
- Open in editor is unavailable while the assistant is still working on a request. In deck mode the same choice opens a PowerPoint file; see "Building a slide deck".

Editing like a document

The main toolbar keeps undo and redo, block style, bold, italic, underline, and inline AI editing close at hand. **Text** opens font, size, advanced styles, color, highlighting, and **Clear formatting**. **Paragraph** opens alignment, lists, and quotes. **More** opens **Copy document** and the **AI edit trail**. Select the intended text before opening a panel; Escape returns to the editor.

- The plus (+) **Insert** button opens links and citations alongside **Web image**, **Chart**, **Table**, **Divider**, and **Page break**. A manual page break starts a new page at your cursor; the editor also paginates longer documents automatically.
- Selecting text shows a floating toolbar beside it with **Ask AI**, block style, bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, link, and highlight.
- Type / at the start of a line for the command menu: AI actions such as **Continue writing** and **Summarize the document**, headings, lists, quotes, a table, a divider, a page break, a web image, or today's date. Keep typing to filter and press Enter to insert.
- Typing shortcuts format as you go: start a line with "#", "##", or "###" and a space for a title, heading, or subheading; "-" or "1." for a list; or ">" for a quote. Type "---" and press Enter for a divider, and wrap words in "**", "*", or "`" for bold, italic, or code.

- Click inside a table to insert or delete rows and columns, turn the header row on or off, or delete the table. Click a picture to set its size (Small, Half, Large, or Full width), alignment, and alt text, or to delete it.
- Pasting from Word, Google Docs, or a web page keeps headings, lists, tables, links, pictures, and emphasis but drops the source's fonts, sizes, and colors so the text matches your document. Ctrl+Shift+V (⌘⇧V on a Mac) pastes plain text.

Editing with AI

- Select a passage and choose **Ask AI** in the floating toolbar, or press Ctrl+J (⌘J on a Mac). With nothing selected, the same command writes new text at the cursor.
- Pick an action — **Improve writing**, **Fix spelling & grammar**, **Make shorter**, **Make longer**, **Simplify language**, **Turn into a bulleted list**, **Turn into a table**, Summarize, or **Use active voice** — or a tone or language, or type your own instruction.
- Review the suggestion. **Changes** marks what was added and removed; **Result** shows the finished text. Nothing in the document changes yet.
- Choose **Replace**, **Insert below**, **Try again**, or **Discard**. To adjust the suggestion instead, type a follow-up such as “shorter” or “add a number” in the box underneath.
- When the instruction asks only for different words (fill the blanks, fix the wording, translate), the suggestion is written into the original text and the review says Original formatting kept: fonts, underlines, tab stops, and blank lines stay as they were. You do not need to add “keep the formatting”. Requests to restyle or restructure replace the passage instead.

An accepted AI edit stays highlighted briefly and is recorded with the document; **More → AI edit trail** highlights the recorded edits again so you can review what changed.

Revise the document you already have

Describe the change in the assistant: shorten a section, change tone, apply a template, or transform the existing paper. Revision requests work from the current document. Ask explicitly to start over, replace, or clear it when that is your intention. The editor keeps instructions separate from the deliverable; review the resulting document and use Undo or a saved version when a change needs correction.

Ask for page layout in plain words, such as “Times New Roman 12, double spaced, 1-inch margins”, and the editor applies it to the page setup directly, with no model call. The rail says Applied … Nothing was rewritten., and the change is one step you can undo. “Templates and page layout” covers templates and layout requests together.

For an existing paper, **Assistant settings → Apply MLA layout** applies double-spaced 12-point Times New Roman, a student heading, centered title, body and reference indents, and a separate Works Cited page without asking a model. It preserves the paper's text and supports Undo. Fill missing student details and verify quotations and sources yourself; formatting is not citation verification.

The page navigator shows the current sheet and total pages outside the document text. Older drafts are paginated when opened, and manual edits reflow after you leave the editor. Page labels do not become part of the exported body.

Status bar, outline, find, and zoom

- The status bar under the page shows the current page, word and character counts, and reading time. When text is selected, it counts the selected words too.
- **Outline** lists the document's headings; select one to jump to that section.
- Find (Ctrl+F, or ⌘F on a Mac) searches the document, with **Match case** and whole-word options. **Find and replace** (Ctrl+H, or ⌘⇧H on a Mac) replaces one match at a time or all of them.
- The keyboard button lists every editor shortcut (Ctrl+/, or ⌘/ on a Mac). The zoom controls resize the page on screen from 50% to 200% without changing the document or its exports.

Versions and comparing

- Click **Save version** whenever the draft reaches a good state. You can restore an earlier version at any time from the draft's history.
- **Compare versions** opens a read-only visual redline of two saved versions, so you can see exactly what changed between them. It needs two genuinely different saved versions before it activates.
- Open **Document history** to browse saved documents and decks. Hover or keyboard-focus an entry for a preview. **Archive** moves finished work into **Archived**, where **Unarchive** restores it; **Delete** requires confirmation and permanently removes the saved item and revisions.
- Read the save status: account-backed documents and decks can be reopened after sign-in on another device. A pending or failed save stays a working copy in this browser. If the chip reads Local only — server save failed, choose Retry beside it; if it reads **Draft** changed elsewhere, choose Reload server copy and review the account version before saving again.

Leaving with unsaved changes

When you leave an edited draft through workspace navigation, open another chat or draft, or choose **Sign out**, the unsaved-changes dialog lets you Keep editing, Save copy and continue, or **Discard** and continue. The saved copy goes into local document history in this browser. If browser storage fails, the app keeps you in the draft so you can recover it. A forced security sign-out can still interrupt work; save important changes regularly.

Exporting

- Click **Export** to open the export panel. In document mode it offers a **Word document** (an editable Word file with preview page breaks and embedded images), **Markdown** (best for plain text or web publishing), and **Print / Save as PDF**, which opens your browser's print dialog with the saved version — choose “Save as PDF” there to keep a PDF copy.
- Exports always run from a saved version. If you have unsaved edits, the panel says **Save your edits first** and offers a one-click **Save version and export** (or **Save version and print**) button.

- When your browser supports it, choose **Choose a location** to select a destination, or **Browser downloads** to use its download folder. If the chosen location cannot be written, the file is sent to your browser downloads instead and the status says so. Word and print retain document formatting; **Markdown** preserves the text without its typography. Exporting a file does not by itself upload pending work to your account.

GOOD TO KNOW

If a provider's content filter withholds the model's reply, **Drafts** changes nothing and says which service withheld it, starting with No local draft was substituted. or No revision was applied. Choose a different model or try again.

TIP

On a narrow window, the assistant rail becomes a slide-out drawer so the editor gets the full screen. Open it with the pen tab on the left edge or Ctrl+. (⌘. on a Mac); resting the mouse on that edge previews it. Press Escape or click the dimmed area to close it.

WALKTHROUGH · 3:37 · HELP › LEARN

Draft documents

Start a document from a blank page, a chat request or reply, or a file; have the assistant write it; edit with AI; save a version; and export it.

Before you begin

- An available model for AI writing and editing. Without one, you can still type, open files, save, and export.
- To open a file in the editor: a Word (.docx or .doc), PDF (.pdf), **Markdown** (.md), text (.txt), or web page (.html) file.

Step by step

1. Choose **Drafts** in the sidebar. A blank document opens, with the **Document** Assistant on the left.
2. Type a title in the title field at the top of the page.
3. In Ask the document assistant, describe the document you need, or choose a suggestion. Choose Apply instruction (the arrow).
4. Wait while the assistant writes on the page. Ready to write returns when it is done.
5. Check the title. If the assistant renamed the document, type your own title again.
6. Select a passage, choose **Ask AI** in the floating toolbar (or press Ctrl+J, ⌘J on a Mac), and choose an action such as **Improve writing**.
7. Review the **Changes** or **Result** view. Original formatting kept means only the words change. Choose **Replace**; **Insert below**, **Try again**, and **Discard** are the alternatives.

8. Choose **Save version** and wait for Saved.
9. Choose **Export**, set Save to to **Browser downloads**, and choose **Word document**. The receipt names the downloaded file.

Path: From a chat request

1. In chat, ask for a document. When chat asks Write this in **Drafts**?, choose Write in **Drafts**.
2. **Drafts** writes it from your request and saves it. See Hand a chat request to **Drafts**.

Path: From a chat reply

1. Under a finished chat reply, choose **Transfer to Drafts**.
2. **Drafts** opens a new document with the reply, saved as Version 1.
3. Continue from step 6 of the main steps.

Path: Open a file from this device

1. Choose Attach file (the paperclip) in the assistant's message box.
2. Under From this device, choose Open in editor, and pick a .docx, .pdf, .doc, .md, .txt, or .html file.
3. Word and PDF files keep their page setup, headers, footers, tab stops, and tables; **Markdown** keeps its headings and lists. The draft you had open stays in **Document history**.
4. Attach to chat instead gives the file to the assistant to read with your next request. See Open a Word or PDF file and keep its formatting.

Path: Write it yourself

1. Click on the page and type. **Markdown** shortcuts work: # and a space starts a title, - and a space starts a list.
2. Type / at the start of a line for the command menu: headings, lists, tables, page breaks, and AI actions.
3. Use **Text**, **Paragraph**, **More**, and **Insert** above the page for formatting. Templates and page layout have their own lesson.

Path: Export formats

1. **Word document**: an editable .docx with page breaks and images.
2. **Markdown**: a .md file for plain text or web publishing.
3. **Print / Save as PDF**: opens the browser's print dialog; choose Save as PDF there.
4. Save to: **Browser downloads** saves straight to your downloads; **Choose a location** asks the browser where to save. If that location cannot be written, the file goes to your downloads and the receipt says so.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The toolbar shows Saved and the version number after **Save version**.
- ✓ The export receipt names the file, for example synthetic-vendor-onboarding-checklist.docx, and offers **Download** again.
- ✓ An opened file shows a note in the assistant rail: the file opened in the editor.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"AI drafting is unavailable." or Model: No models connected	No model is available to you. You can still type, open files, save, and export. Ask your administrator for model access.
"No local draft was substituted. …'s content filter withheld the model's reply (… sent the request to …). Choose a different model or try again."	The model provider's safety filter blocked the reply, so nothing was written to your page. Choose a different model in the model menu, or rephrase and try again. During an edit the message starts with "No revision was applied."
The document title changed to a template name, such as Board Update Draft	The assistant can rename a new document after a template it matched. Type your own title back into the title field, then save.
"Could not open … Choose a .docx, .pdf, .doc, .md, .txt, or .html file."	Save the file in one of those formats and open it again.
"Wait for the assistant to finish before opening another document."	Let the current request finish, then open the file.
Export says "Save your edits first"	Choose **Save version and export** (or **Save version and print**). Exports use the saved version.
"Local only — server save failed"	Your changes are kept in this browser. Choose Retry beside it, or export a copy before you leave.
"… could not be written to the chosen location, so it was sent to your browser downloads instead."	The browser could not save to the place you chose. Find the file in your downloads, or set Save to to **Browser downloads**.
"Could not export … Try again from the export menu."	**Try again**, or choose **Browser downloads** in Save to.

17. Hand a chat request to Drafts

Send a document or deck request from chat straight into the editor.

When a chat message asks for a document (a memo, a letter, a report) or a slide deck, the message waits above the composer with a card. Write this in **Drafts**? offers Write in **Drafts** or Continue in chat; for slides, Build this as a slide deck? offers Build in deck editor or **Draft** slides in chat. Nothing is sent until you choose.

- Write in **Drafts** (or Build in deck editor) opens **Drafts** and starts the document or deck from your request, with no retyping. The rail says Writing the document you asked for in chat. The chat's model (unless you starred a drafting default), its **Web** and knowledge choices, your attached files, and earlier messages in the conversation travel with the request; the card notes when your files and this conversation come along.
- Continue in chat (or **Draft** slides in chat) sends the message to the chat as usual.
- Edit request puts the message back in the composer so you can change it. While the card is waiting, Send is disabled: Choose **Drafts** or chat for the request above first.
- The card is not offered in **Agent** mode, with selected tools, for fetched links, or for queued automations, and outlines, summaries, emails, poems, code, and questions about writing stay in chat. **Transfer to Drafts** under any reply still sends a finished answer to the editor.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:35 · HELP › LEARN

Hand a chat request to Drafts

Ask chat for a document or a slide deck, then have Drafts write it as an editable, saved draft, or keep it in chat, or change the request first.

Before you begin

- An available model. **Chat** only offers **Drafts** when a model is available to you.
- **Agent** mode off, with no tools or links chosen for the message. Those requests always go straight to chat.

Step by step

1. In a chat, ask for a document, for example: **Draft** a one-page memo to the operations team about the vendor review schedule.
2. Send it. **Chat** holds the request and asks Write this in **Drafts**? Send stays off until you choose.
3. Choose Write in **Drafts**.
4. **Drafts** opens and starts writing at once. The rail says Writing the document you asked for in chat.
5. Wait for Ready to write to return and for Saved in the toolbar. The document is Version 1 in your account.
6. Read it through, then edit, save, and export it as in **Draft** documents.

Path: Ask for a slide deck

1. Ask for a presentation, for example: **Create** a slide deck about the vendor review timeline, with four slides.
2. **Chat** asks Build this as a slide deck?
3. Choose Build in deck editor. **Drafts** switches to **Deck** and the rail says Building the slide deck you asked for in chat.
4. Wait for the slides to fill the filmstrip and for Saved in the toolbar.

Path: Keep it in chat

1. Choose Continue in chat (for a deck, **Draft** slides in chat).
2. The request is sent to this conversation and the reply arrives as usual.
3. To move a finished reply to **Drafts** later, choose **Transfer to Drafts** under it.

Path: Change the request first

1. Choose Edit request.
2. The request returns to the message box, with any files you attached. Change it and send it again.

Path: When the card does not appear

1. **Agent** mode, chosen tools, fetched links, and queued automations always send straight to chat.
2. Questions and short pieces stay in chat: emails, poems, summaries, outlines, recaps, posts, and code.
3. Adding in chat or right here to a request keeps it in chat.
4. Attached files, **Web**, and knowledge bases you chose come along to **Drafts**.

Check that it worked

- ✓ **Drafts** shows the document with Version 1 and Saved in the toolbar; a deck shows its slides in the filmstrip.
- ✓ The rail in **Drafts** records your request and the model that wrote it.
- ✓ Continue in chat puts the request and its reply in the conversation instead.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Send is off, and its tooltip says "Choose Drafts or chat for the request above first"	**Chat** is holding your request. Choose Write in **Drafts**, Continue in chat, or Edit request.
"Could not upload the attachment." on the card	A file you attached could not be uploaded. **Try again**, or choose Edit request and attach it again.
No card appears and the reply arrives in chat	The request read as a question or a short piece, or **Agent** mode, a tool, or a link was on. **Open Drafts** and ask there, or use **Transfer to Drafts** under the reply.
The new document has a template's name, such as Investment Memo Draft	The assistant renamed it after a template it matched. Type your own title into the title field, then save.
"No drafting model connected" in Drafts	**Drafts** has no model to write with. Your request waits in the assistant's message box; ask your administrator for model access.
"Provider drafting could not complete: …" or "Deck request failed: …"	The model could not finish. Choose Apply instruction to try again, or pick another model in the model menu.

18. Open a Word or PDF file and keep its formatting

Edit an existing Word or PDF document in Drafts without losing its layout.

Open in editor turns a file from your device into the document itself. Word files (.docx, .dotx, .doc) and PDF files keep their page size and margins, headers and footers, page numbers, tab stops, and tables, so a contract or form looks the way it did. Edits and AI suggestions then work on that layout.

- Click the paperclip in the assistant's message box, choose Open in editor under From this device, and pick the file. It opens as a new draft and is saved to your account.
- Select a passage and choose **Ask AI**. When you ask only for different words, the review says Original formatting kept and the result keeps the original fonts, underlines, and tab stops.
- **Save version**, then **Export → Word document** to take it back to Word. The import note in the assistant rail lists anything that could not be carried over.
- To reuse a Word file's look for new drafts instead, open Templates in the assistant rail and choose Upload Word template.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:58 · HELP › LEARN

Open a Word or PDF file and keep its formatting

Open a Word or PDF file in Drafts with its page setup, headers, footers, tab stops, and tables intact, fill it in with Ask AI without losing the formatting, and export it back to Word.

Before you begin

- A Word (.docx, .dotx, or .doc) or PDF file on this device. A .docx keeps the most; a .doc opens from its readable text.
- An available model for **Ask AI**. Opening, editing, saving, and exporting work without one.
- PDFs must not be password-protected.

Step by step

1. Choose **Drafts** in the sidebar.
2. Choose Attach file (the paperclip) in the assistant's message box. Under From this device, choose Open in editor.
3. Pick the .docx file. It opens as a new draft with its page size, margins, fonts, header, footer with page numbers, tab stops, and tables. The rail says it opened in the editor.
4. Select the passage to change, then choose **Ask AI** in the floating toolbar.
5. Type the change, for example Fill in the blanks with synthetic values, and press Enter.
6. Review the suggestion. Original formatting kept means only the words change: bold text, fonts, and styles stay as they were. Choose **Replace**.
7. Choose **Save version** and wait for Saved.
8. Choose **Export**, set Save to to **Browser downloads**, and choose **Word document**. The receipt names the file.
9. Open the downloaded file in Word: the header, footer, page numbers, tab stops, and table are still there.

Path: Open a PDF

1. Choose Attach file › Open in editor and pick the .pdf file.
2. It is rebuilt as editable paragraphs with its page size, margins, fonts, and running header and footer. Page numbers become live fields.
3. Edit, save, and export it like any draft. **Word document** export gives you an editable .docx.

Path: Reuse a Word file as a template

1. Choose Templates in the assistant rail.
2. Choose Upload Word template (the upload button at the bottom of Templates) and pick the file.

3. On a blank page it places the template. On a page with text, it applies the template's page, header, footer, and styles without removing any words.
4. The template is listed under Uploaded in Templates, stored in this browser.

Path: Other files and Attach to chat

1. **Markdown** (.md), text (.txt), and web page (.html) files open the same way; **Markdown** keeps its headings and lists.
2. Attach to chat, instead of Open in editor, gives the file to the assistant to read with your next request.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The page shows the file's header and footer, with live page numbers such as Page 1 of 1.
- ✓ The review showed Original formatting kept, and the filled passage keeps its bold text.
- ✓ The toolbar shows Saved, and the export receipt names the .docx file.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Could not open … Choose a .docx, .pdf, .doc, .md, .txt, or .html file."	Save the file in one of those formats and open it again.
"This PDF is password-protected. Remove the password and try again." or "The PDF could not be read."	Remove the password, or save a fresh PDF from the app that made it, then open it again.
Text from a PDF opens bolder than it was	Some PDF fonts (for example Georgia or Times New Roman in a PDF printed from a browser) can open as bold or semibold. Select the text and set its weight back, or open the original Word file instead when you have it.
"The Word file's full formatting could not be read, so it opened with simplified formatting."	Open the file in Word, save it again as .docx, and open the new copy.
"Legacy .doc files are imported from readable text or Word-saved HTML. Use .docx for higher fidelity."	Save the file as .docx in Word, then open it again to keep its formatting.
The review does not say Original formatting kept	The change restyled or restructured the passage (into a list or table, for example), so the reply replaces it as written. Check it, or choose **Discard** and ask for a smaller change.
"Wait for the assistant to finish before opening another document."	Let the current request finish, then open the file.

19. Templates and page layout

Start from a template, restyle a draft, and set the page layout in plain words.

Templates in the assistant rail lists document templates by category: Client Update, Approval Email, Legal Contract, Mutual NDA, Contract Amendment, Investment Memo, Board Update, Project Brief, Research Paper, Screenplay, and Implementation Plan. On an empty draft a template starts the document; on a draft with text it sets the draft in that template's layout without changing its words.

- **Use templates in chat** (off by default) lets the selected template shape what the assistant writes for new drafts.
- Upload Word template uses your own .docx or .dotx file as the layout.

- Type a layout request in the assistant, such as “Times New Roman 12, double spaced, 1-inch margins”. It is applied directly with no model call: Applied … Nothing was rewritten. Undo reverses it in one step.
- **Assistant settings** → **Apply MLA layout** formats a student paper; see “Drafting documents”.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:48 · HELP › LEARN

Start from a template and set the page layout

Start a document from a built-in template, have the assistant draft it from your request, and set line spacing, margins, and other page layout in plain words or with the MLA layout.

Before you begin

- An available model to draft from a template. Placing a template and changing the layout work without one.

Step by step

1. Choose **Drafts** in the sidebar. In the assistant rail, choose Templates.
2. Choose a category, such as Legal, then a template, such as Mutual NDA. On a blank page it places the template, with bracketed fields to fill in.
3. In Ask the document assistant, describe what to fill in: the parties, the date, and the purpose.
4. Choose **Create** Mutual NDA draft at the bottom of Templates. The assistant drafts the document from the template and your request.
5. Wait for Ready to write and Saved in the toolbar, then read the draft through.
6. In Ask the document assistant, type the layout you want in plain words, for example Use 1.5 line spacing and 1.25-inch margins, and press Enter.
7. The rail says the layout was applied directly in the editor and no model call was needed. No words were rewritten.
8. Choose **Save version** and wait for Saved.

Path: Fill in the brackets yourself

1. After placing a template, type over each bracketed field, such as [Party A Legal Name].
2. Save a version when you are done.

Path: Apply a template to text you already have

1. Open the draft, choose Templates, and choose a template, such as Contract Amendment.
2. Its page setup, header, footer, and styles are applied. Your text is unchanged.
3. To reorganize the text into the template's sections, ask the assistant.

Path: Layout you can ask for

1. Line spacing: single, 1.5, or double.
2. Margins for every side or one side, in inches, centimeters, millimeters, or points.
3. Font and size, paper size (Letter, Legal, or A4), and landscape or portrait.
4. Justified or left-aligned text, first-line indents, paragraph gaps, page numbers, and header or footer text.
5. A named format: contract, letter, memo, report, academic, or screenplay.

Path: MLA layout

1. Choose **Assistant settings** (the gear at the top of the rail).
2. Choose **Apply MLA layout**: double spacing, 12-point Times New Roman, and a centered title. Your text is kept.
3. Undo reverses it. Save a version to keep it.

Path: Use templates in chat

1. In Templates, turn on **Use templates in chat**.
2. The selected template then shapes the new drafts you ask the assistant for.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The page shows the drafted agreement with the parties and date from your request.
- ✓ The rail records your layout request and that no model call was needed, and the page shows the new spacing and margins.
- ✓ The toolbar shows Saved after **Save version**.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
A layout request was rewritten by the model instead of applied	The request mixed layout with other changes. Ask for the layout on its own, in plain words such as 1.5 line spacing and 1-inch margins.
A layout request changes nothing on a paper in MLA layout	MLA papers keep their layout (screen readers hear "This paper is set in MLA layout (12-point Times New Roman, double spaced); its layout is not changed here."). Undo the MLA layout first if you need a different one.
Create … draft is off	No model is available to you. Place the template and fill in the brackets yourself, or ask your administrator for model access.
The document title changed to the template's name	Type your own title into the title field, then save.

20. Building a slide deck

Turn a draft into slides, edit them, brand them, and export real PowerPoint.

Deck mode turns the **Drafts** workspace into a slide editor with a real PowerPoint export. Click the **Deck** button on the **Draft format** switch. If the draft already has document content, a dialog asks “Turn this draft into slides?” — choose **Start a blank deck** to keep the document untouched, or **Convert into slides** to split its headings and text into slides. Your document versions are kept either way.

The filmstrip

- Slide thumbnails run along the side. Click one to select it, or drag it to reorder the deck.
- Hover a thumbnail for its actions: move up, move down, duplicate, and delete (undo restores a deleted slide).
- **Add slide** at the end of the filmstrip opens the Add a slide panel on the left, where you pick the new slide's layout.
- **Slide sorter**, at the right of the deck toolbar, lays every slide out in a grid. Drag to reorder, double-click a slide to edit it, and use each slide's duplicate and delete buttons.

Slide layouts

Above the slide, **Layouts** previews seven arrangements: **Title**, **Title + bullets**, **Two columns**, **Image + caption**, **Section**, **Quote**, and **Closing**. Select one to switch the selected slide. The layout chip in the slide's corner opens the Change layout panel on the left, with the same layouts grouped as Openers, Content, Pictures, and Highlights. **Themes** offers five color palettes — Aperture, Midnight, Editorial, Violet, and Forest;

a palette change recolors every slide, keeps text, media, and layout, and can be undone. The chevron beside **Layouts** folds the strip away to give the slide more room.

Editing slide text

- Click any text region on a slide to edit it in place. A floating text toolbar appears beside the box: **Ask AI**, font size, Bold, Italic, Underline, Strikethrough, **Text** color with the deck's **Theme colors**, list level, and **Clear formatting**. With nothing highlighted it formats the whole box; highlight words to format only those. The deck toolbar above keeps undo and redo, **Text**, and **More** (copy the deck outline, keyboard shortcuts).
- When text no longer fits its box, the toolbar says **Text** overflows this box · shorten it, size it down, or drag a corner. Until you do, the slide shrinks the text to fit (Shrunk to fit, as PowerPoint does), and the PowerPoint export uses the same shrink.
- Drag a text box by its frame to move it. Guides snap it to the slide's edges and center and to other boxes; arrow keys nudge the selected box (Shift moves ten times as far).
- Inside bullet lists, press Tab to indent a bullet one level and Shift+Tab to outdent it.

Editing slides with AI

- **Edit slide with AI** (the AI pen in the deck toolbar, or Ctrl+J / ⌘J) opens the **Edit slide with AI** panel on the left and reworks the whole slide: **Improve this slide**, **Make it punchier**, **Cut the text in half**, **Write speaker notes**, **Pick a better layout**, **Split into two slides**, **Fix spelling & grammar**, a tone or language, or your own instruction.
- The review in the panel shows the slide before and after, plus any new speaker notes. Choose **Apply to slide**, **Try again**, or **Discard**; undo restores the previous slide.
- When the deck assistant builds or revises slides, it runs a fit check before you review them. Checking slide fit appears while it measures; Fit check: every slide's text fits its boxes. means nothing needed changing, otherwise it rewrites the text that was too large and says which slides it changed.
- To rewrite only part of a slide, highlight the text and choose **Ask AI**, then review the suggestion before replacing it.

Opening a PowerPoint file

- In deck mode, click the paperclip in the assistant's message box and choose Open in editor (Edit slides directly) to open a .pptx file as the deck itself.
- Each slide keeps its title, subtitle, bullets with their indent levels, two-column text, speaker notes, one picture, and its layout artwork as the background. **Text** with no place in the chosen layout moves into that slide's speaker notes instead of disappearing.
- If the presentation is larger than the deck limit, pictures are left out first and then layout artwork, and the assistant rail says so. The opened deck is a new deck; the deck you had open stays in **Document history**.

Starter templates and your brand template

- **Deck starters & brand themes**, above the slide (or the Templates chip in the assistant rail), opens the templates panel with five starter structures: **Pitch deck**, **Quarterly review**, **Project kickoff**, **Client proposal**, and **Training session**. Pick one and start it to get scaffold slides you replace.
- A **Use templates in chat** toggle (off by default) lets the selected template guide the deck assistant when it drafts for you.
- **Upload brand template** accepts your firm's own file — ".pptx or .potx — brand colors, fonts, logo, and every slide's text are extracted." The extracted theme is stored only on this device.
- **Once** a brand theme is loaded, **Apply to deck** restyles the current deck with its colors, fonts, and logo, and a "Load all N slides" button can replace the deck with every slide from the uploaded template.

Slide pictures

- Slide pictures in the deck toolbar opens the Slide picture panel on the left. Upload from this device adds a **PNG**, JPEG, WebP, or GIF; or type a description under Or describe the picture and choose Find web images (needs web search) or **Generate** AI picture (needs an image-generation model for your workspace).
- Alt text describes the picture for screen readers and is kept in the PowerPoint export. If the slide's layout has no place for a picture, the panel offers layouts that do.

Backgrounds and AI images

- The background button in the toolbar opens a per-slide menu: **Upload background…** (a **PNG**, JPEG, or WebP from this device), **Use on every slide**, **Remove from this slide**, and **Clear from all slides**.
- **Generate AI slide image** writes an image prompt for you, prefilled from the slide's content; press **Generate image** and the result becomes that slide's background. This needs an image-generation model enabled for your workspace — the button says so honestly when none is.
- In the assistant rail, **Toggle AI slide images** makes the assistant also generate an image for every slide whenever it drafts a deck.

Speaker notes

Every slide has a **Speaker notes** field below the stage. **Notes** export with the deck: they land in each slide's notes pane in the PowerPoint file, they appear in the **Markdown outline**, and they follow you into presentation mode.

Presenting from Aperture

- Click **Present deck** in the deck toolbar (the monitor icon), or press F5 (⌘Enter on a Mac); add Shift to start from the current slide. The deck opens full screen.
- Advance by clicking the slide or with the arrow keys or Space; move back with the left arrow. Type a slide number and press Enter to jump to it.

- The **Notes** button (or N) shows your speaker notes under the slide. **Presenter view** (or P) shows the current slide, the next slide, a timer you can pause or reset, and your notes side by side.
- Press B or W to black or white out the screen; press it again to return. Leave with Escape or the **Exit** button in the top corner.

Saving and exporting

- **Save version** stores decks to your account with revision history, like documents. Read the status to confirm the save reached the server. A local working copy or pending save remains only in this browser until synchronization succeeds; use the **Only on this device** reminder to find unfinished saves.
- **Document history** includes decks. Preview, reopen, archive, unarchive, and confirmed deletion use the same account controls as documents. A concurrent account edit can prevent a stale save or deletion; read the conflict message before retrying.
- Click **Export** to open the **Export deck** panel: **PowerPoint deck** produces an editable .pptx that mirrors the slides on screen — speaker notes included in each slide's notes pane — and **Markdown outline** exports slide titles, bullets, and speaker notes as text.
- Limits: a deck holds up to 100 slides and 8 MB of content. The editor tells you plainly if a deck exceeds them.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:50 · HELP › LEARN

Build a slide deck

Turn a document into slides, build a deck from an outline or a starter template, apply your brand, present it, and export a PowerPoint file.

Before you begin

- An available model for the deck assistant. Converting a document, templates, layouts, notes, presenting, and export work without one.
- Optional: your organization's PowerPoint brand template (.pptx or .potx, up to 30 MB, no macros).

Step by step

1. Choose **Drafts** in the sidebar, then choose **Deck** in the **Draft format** switch. A blank deck opens with the **Deck** Assistant.
2. Type a title for the deck.
3. In Ask the deck assistant, describe the deck: how many slides and what each covers. Choose Apply instruction.
4. Wait while Building slides… runs; on smaller models this can take a few minutes. The filmstrip fills, and the rail says how many slides were drafted and reports its fit check.
5. Review each slide. **Add slide**, the slide's layout chip, Slide pictures, and **Edit slide with AI** open panels on the left (see Edit slides: layouts, pictures, and text).

6. Add speaker notes under the slide.
7. Choose **Save version** and wait for Saved.
8. Choose **Present deck**, then press P for presenter view. Escape exits.
9. Choose **Export**, set Save to to **Browser downloads**, and choose **PowerPoint deck**. The receipt names the .pptx file.

Path: Convert a document

1. In a document with content, choose **Deck** in the **Draft format** switch.
2. Turn this draft into slides? appears. Choose **Convert into slides** (or **Start a blank deck**).
3. The headings become slides. Your document versions are kept either way.

Path: Start from a template

1. In a deck, choose **Deck starters & brand themes**.
2. Choose a starter: **Pitch deck**, **Quarterly review**, **Project kickoff**, **Client proposal**, or **Training session**.
3. Choose Start and the template's name. **Replace** the scaffold text with your content.

Path: Your brand template

1. In **Deck starters & brand themes**, choose Upload under Brand theme and pick your .pptx or .potx file.
2. On a deck with slides, the brand's colors, fonts, logo, and background are applied at once; Applied — remove takes them off, and **Apply to deck** applies a stored brand again.
3. Load all N slides replaces the deck with the template's own slide designs. The brand theme is stored only on this device.

Path: Layouts and themes

1. The strip above the slide has **Layouts** (for the selected slide) and **Themes** (for every slide).
2. Fold away layouts and themes hides the strip for more room; Show layouts and themes brings it back.

Path: Present

1. Choose **Present deck**. Arrow keys, Space, or a click move forward.
2. Press N to show notes, P for presenter view (timer, next slide, notes), and B to black out the screen.
3. Press Escape, or choose **Exit**, to leave.

Path: Export formats

1. **PowerPoint deck**: an editable .pptx with your slides, pictures, alt text, and speaker notes.
2. **Markdown outline**: slide titles, bullets, and notes as text.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The filmstrip lists the slides, and the rail reports how many the assistant drafted and its fit check.
- ✓ **Presenter view** shows the current slide, a timer, the next slide, and your notes.
- ✓ The export receipt names the .pptx file.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Building slides… runs for several minutes	Larger decks take longer, especially on smaller models. Ask for fewer slides, or wait; your draft stays intact meanwhile.
Generate AI picture is off: "No image-generation model is enabled for your workspace"	Your workspace has no image model. Upload your own picture from Slide pictures instead.
"Could not open … Choose a PowerPoint .pptx file."	Open in editor in a deck accepts .pptx and .potx files. Save other formats as .pptx first.
"… exceeds the 30 MB brand-template upload limit." or "Macro-enabled presentations are not accepted. Save as .pptx or .potx first."	Use a smaller template, and save it without macros.
After a brand is applied, slide text is hard to read on its background	Some brand templates pair a dark background with dark text. Choose Load all N slides to start from the template's own slide designs, or recolor the text with **Text** color.
"Brand template upload failed: …"	Check that the file is a valid PowerPoint template and try again.

21. Editing slides: layouts, pictures, and text

Add slides, change layouts, place pictures, format text, and edit with AI in the slide panel.

The panel on the left of the deck editor handles slide-by-slide work. **Add slide** opens Add a slide, the layout chip on a slide opens Change layout, Slide pictures opens Slide picture, and **Edit slide with AI** opens the AI review. Close the panel with its X or Escape; drag its edge to resize it.

- Pick a layout from Openers, Content, Pictures, or Highlights. Changing layout keeps the slide's text; if some items have no slot in the new layout, the status says so and Undo restores them.
- Add a picture with Upload from this device, Find web images, or **Generate** AI picture, and give it Alt text.
- Select text for the floating text toolbar: size, Bold, **Text** color with **Theme colors**, list level, and **Clear formatting**. Overflowing text shrinks to fit until you shorten it or enlarge the box.
- **Save version** when the slides look right; the PowerPoint export matches what you see.

WALKTHROUGH · 3:10 · HELP › LEARN

Edit slides: layouts, pictures, and text

Add slides from the layout panel, change a slide's layout, add a picture with alt text, format slide text, fix text that no longer fits, and edit a slide with AI.

Before you begin

- A deck open in **Drafts**. Build a slide deck shows how to start one.
- An available model for **Edit slide with AI** and the deck assistant. **Layouts**, pictures, and text formatting work without one.
- A picture on this device: **PNG**, JPEG, WebP, or GIF.
- **Generate** AI picture needs an image-generation model in your workspace.

Step by step

1. In the filmstrip, select the slide the new one should follow, then choose **Add slide** under the filmstrip.
2. In Add a slide, pick a layout. Openers, Content, Pictures, and Highlights jump to each group. The slide is added after the selected one.
3. Click a text box on the new slide and type over the placeholder text.
4. To change the slide's layout, choose the layout chip at the top right of the slide (for example **Two columns**), then pick a layout in Change layout. The slide keeps its words.
5. Choose Slide pictures in the toolbar. In the Picture panel, choose Upload from this device and pick a picture.
6. Type a short description in Alt text, then choose **Done**.
7. Select words in a text box. In the floating text toolbar, change the size, choose Bold, or choose **Text** color and a theme color. **Clear formatting** returns the text to the layout's style.
8. If the toolbar says Shrunk to fit, as PowerPoint does, or **Text** overflows this box, shorten the text, size it down, or drag a corner of the box.
9. Choose **Edit slide with AI** in the toolbar and pick an action such as **Cut the text in half**. Compare Before and After in the left panel.

10. Choose **Apply to slide**. **Try again** asks for another version; **Discard** leaves the slide as it was.
11. Choose **Save version** and wait for Saved.

Path: Find a picture on the web

1. In the Picture panel, type a few words in Or describe the picture, then choose Find web images.
2. Choose a result to use it on the slide.
3. If nothing comes back, the panel says No web images were found. Try other words, or upload your own picture.

Path: Generate an AI picture

1. Describe the picture in Or describe the picture, then choose **Generate** AI picture.
2. It needs an image-generation model. Without one the button is off and the panel says No image-generation model is enabled for your workspace.

Path: Edit only some of the text with AI

1. **Highlight** words in a text box, then choose **Ask AI** in the floating text toolbar.
2. The left panel opens as Edit slide text with AI and changes only the highlighted words.
3. Type what to change or pick an action, review the **Changes**, and choose **Replace**.

Path: Have the deck assistant revise every slide

1. In Ask the deck assistant, describe the change, for example Make every slide title five words or fewer, and choose Apply instruction.
2. While it works, the rail lists its steps, including Checking slide fit.
3. When it finishes, the rail reports the result and the fit check, for example Fit check: every slide's text fits its boxes.

Path: Slide background

1. Choose Slide background in the toolbar.
2. **Upload background…** puts your own image behind this slide. **Use on every slide**, **Remove from this slide**, and **Clear from all slides** manage it.

Path: More room for the slide

1. Fold away layouts and themes (the arrow beside **Layouts**) hides the strip above the slide.
2. Show layouts and themes brings it back.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The filmstrip shows the new slide with its layout name, for example Slide 3: **Image + caption**.
- ✓ The picture is on the slide, and Alt text holds its description, which is kept in the PowerPoint export.
- ✓ After **Apply to slide**, the slide shows the After version, and the toolbar shows Saved after **Save version**.
- ✓ The rail's fit check reports that every slide's text fits its boxes.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Pictures can be PNG, JPEG, WebP, or GIF."	Save the picture in one of those formats and upload it again.
"… has no picture. Switch this slide to a layout that holds one; its words come along."	Choose **Image + caption** under **Layouts** with a picture, then add the picture.
"No web images were found for … Try other words."	Try other words, or upload your own picture. The search reaches public web pictures, so it needs internet access from your browser.
Generate AI picture is off: "No image-generation model is enabled for your workspace"	Upload your own picture, or ask your administrator for an image model.
"Text overflows this box · shorten it, size it down, or drag a corner"	Shorten the text, choose a smaller size, drag a corner of the box, or use **Edit slide with AI** and **Cut the text in half**.
Bullets after the eighth disappear when you leave the slide	A bullet box keeps up to eight bullets; extra lines are not saved. Shorten the list, or use **Edit slide with AI** and **Split into two slides**.
"… had no slot in this layout — undo restores them."	The new layout has fewer text boxes. Undo, or pick a layout with more boxes.
Edit slide with AI is off	No model is available to you. Ask your administrator for model access; layouts, pictures, and formatting still work.

22. Recover work kept only on this device

Distinguish a browser working copy from a completed account save.

The sidebar's **Only on this device** reminder appears when work has changes kept in this browser that have not reached your account. It can include chats whose last save failed, documents or decks with unsent

changes, and older history from before account sync.

- Open the reminder to review the named items. For chats whose last save failed, choose **Retry all** and check the resulting save state.
- For documents and decks, choose **Open Drafts**, open the item, and save it to your account. Review any load, quota, connection, or conflict error before leaving the browser.
- Older browser history remains separate until you explicitly import each item from **Drafts** → **Document history** with **Import to my account**. Confirm the item belongs in this account before importing.
- **Archive** finished drafts when you want them out of the active list. **Account** archives remain recoverable; archiving a browser-only item does not prove it has been uploaded.

GOOD TO KNOW

Clear list dismisses these reminders without deleting or uploading work. New edits may appear again. **Hide this reminder** turns off this account's sidebar notice in this browser; save status remains in **Drafts** and chats. Downloading an export also leaves pending account saves to be resolved.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:12 · HELP › LEARN

Save, organize, and recover your drafts

Save documents and decks to your account, reopen them from Document history, archive and restore them, return to an earlier version, and recover work kept only on this device.

Before you begin

- At least one document or deck in **Drafts**.

Step by step

1. In a document or deck, choose **Save version** and wait for Saved in the toolbar.
2. Choose **Document history** (the clock at the top of the assistant rail).
3. Point at a card to preview it, or choose the card to reopen that draft.
4. To put finished work away, point at its card and choose **Archive**. **Draft** archived. Open **Archived** to restore it. confirms it.
5. Choose **Archived** to find it, then choose **Unarchive** to bring it back to Active.
6. Under Versions of this draft, choose a version to return to it.
7. **Delete** is separate: choose **Delete**, read the confirmation, then choose **Delete** draft or **Cancel**.

Path: When a save fails

1. Local only — server save failed means the latest changes are kept in this browser but have not reached your account.
2. Choose Retry beside it once you are back online, or export a copy before you leave.

3. If **Draft** changed elsewhere appears, keep your local changes safe (export), then choose Reload server copy beside it.

Path: Only on this device

1. The sidebar reminder counts items only on this device. Choose it to open the list.
2. **Retry all** retries chat saves. **Open Drafts** opens **Drafts**: in **Document history**, drafts with unsent changes are marked Local changes. Open one and choose Retry.
3. **Clear list** dismisses the current reminders; **Hide this reminder** hides the notice. Neither uploads nor deletes your work.

Path: Leaving with unsaved edits

1. Keep your unsaved edits? appears when you leave or open something else.
2. Choose Keep editing, Save copy and continue, or **Discard** and continue.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Saved appears in the toolbar with the version number.
- ✓ The draft is listed under **Archived** after archiving, and under Active after **Unarchive**.
- ✓ Versions of this draft lists each saved version with its time.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Local only — server save failed" with Retry beside it ("Local only — … Your changes are kept on this device.")	The server save failed, and your changes are kept in this browser. Check your connection and choose Retry, or export a copy before you close the browser.
"Not saved — …, and browser storage could not keep a copy."	Keep the workspace open, then retry or export your changes.
"this draft exceeds the 2 MB server draft limit" (or the 8 MB deck limit)	Split the document, or remove large images, then save again.
"Draft changed elsewhere" with Reload server copy beside it	Another tab or device saved this draft. **Export** your local version if you need it, then choose Reload server copy.
"Save two different versions of this draft to compare them"	**Compare versions** needs two saved versions that differ. Save again after an edit.

23. Agent profiles

Reusable bundles of model, prompts, knowledge, and tools.

An agent profile bundles a model route, meta prompts, knowledge bases, and MCP tools into one reusable configuration. A usable profile needs an approved, enabled model backed by a working provider. A saved profile marked not connected is a configuration example, not proof that it can run.

Creating an agent

- If your account has agent authoring permission, click **Agents** in the sidebar, then **New Agent**.
- Give it a name and a short description of what it is for.
- Work through the editor tabs: **Profile** (name, model, and description), **Knowledge** (assign knowledge bases), **Tools** (select MCP tools), **Prompts & Skills** (attach system prompts and skill files), **Access** (who can use it), and **Hermes** (the optional learning companion).
- Click the save button. Standard users create private profiles; administrators control group sharing and organization publishing. Check model readiness and access before trying the profile in chat.

Using an agent in chat

- Type @ in the composer and pick an available profile to use its configured model route, instructions, knowledge, and tools.
- The **Agent** switch in **Send options** can choose the first available profile when none is selected. Check **Agent profile** and select the intended configuration before sending.
- If no profiles appear, ask your administrator to check that a ready profile is available to your account.

From the **Agents** view you can also open a profile to edit it, jump straight into a chat with it, or delete it. The Automations tab at the top of this view holds your scheduled runs — covered in "Scheduled automations".

WALKTHROUGH · 2:06 · HELP › LEARN

Agent profiles

Build a private agent with its own instructions, model, knowledge, and skill files, then use it in chat and check that the reply follows it.

Before you begin

- Permission to build agents: your platform owner allows users to build their own agents, and your administrator grants **Can build agents** to one of your groups. Until then, **Agents** says Building agents is not available to you.
- An available model for the agent to use.
- Optional: knowledge bases, tools, prompts, and skill files shared with you, to attach to the agent.

- **Agents** that use the **Hermes** companion also need **Can use Hermes companion** on one of your groups. Until then they show Needs **Hermes** approval from your administrator, and you cannot chat with them.

Step by step

1. Choose **Agents** in the sidebar, then **New Agent**.
2. On **Profile**, type an **Agent** name and choose the AI model. Optionally start from a template such as Research Analyst.
3. In System prompt, write the agent's instructions: its role, what it should produce, and what it must never do. Meta prompt adds standing rules on every turn.
4. On **Knowledge**, tick the knowledge bases it should search on every message.
5. On **Tools**, tick any tools it may use in agent mode; tools that need approval ask before they run.
6. On **Prompts & Skills**, tick saved prompts and skill files to add to its instructions.
7. On **Access**, read Private — only you can use this agent.
8. Choose **Create** agent and wait for the agent's name followed by created. It is ready to use in chat.
9. In a chat, type @ and choose the agent, then type your question and send it.
10. Check the reply: the trace reads **Agent** work trace, and the answer follows the agent's instructions and cites its knowledge.

Path: Use it from Send options

1. **Send options** › **Agent**, then choose the profile in **Agent profile**.
2. Check the selected profile before sending; turning **Agent** on can select the first one.

Path: Use it from the Agents page

1. On the agent's card or in its editor, choose **Chat** (or Use in **Chat**).
2. A chat opens with **Agent** mode on for that agent.

Path: Edit, duplicate, or delete

1. On the agent's card, choose Edit, change the settings, and choose Save **Profile**.
2. **More** actions on the card offers Duplicate and **Delete**.

Path: Share it

1. **Agents** you build stay private to your account.
2. Ask an administrator to share the agent with a group.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The agent appears under **Agents** with your chosen model.
- ✓ In chat, the **Agent** chip shows the agent, and the reply's trace reads **Agent** work trace with Preparing agent tools and the knowledge search.
- ✓ The answer follows the instructions you wrote (here, it opens with three bullet points from the playbook) and offers its citations.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Building agents is not available to you."	Your groups lack **Can build agents**, or the service policy does not allow user-built agents. Ask your administrator.
"Select a base AI model and enter an agent name before saving."	Type a name and choose an available model in AI model.
"… is not connected, so the agent cannot answer."	The agent's model has no working provider. Choose another model in **Profile** and save.
"Knowledge base … is turned off, so the agent answers without it."	Ask the knowledge base's owner to turn it back on, or untick it.
An agent card says "Needs Hermes approval from your administrator", or chat says "… uses the Hermes companion, which your administrator hasn't turned on for your groups."	That agent uses the **Hermes** companion. Ask your administrator to turn on **Can use Hermes companion** for one of your groups.
"No agent profiles available yet — create one under Agents" when typing @	You have no agents yet, or none is shared with you. Build one, or ask your administrator.
The reply ignores part of the instructions	Smaller models follow short, specific instructions best. Shorten the System prompt, or choose a stronger model.

PART 4

Library and automations

24. Knowledge bases

Give chats grounded, citable access to your documents, web pages, and APIs.

Knowledge lives in the **Library**: click **Library** in the sidebar, then the **Knowledge** tab. The **Knowledge Bases** panel lists every collection with its status, security posture, and whether it is enabled.

- Click New knowledge base and name the collection.
- Choose what feeds it. A knowledge base can start from Upload files (PDFs, Office files, email, images, audio, and video), Add web pages (public pages, re-fetched whenever you sync), or **Connect an API** (JSON or text from an endpoint, with a key or sign-in).
- **Connect an API** needs its own permission. Without it the choice is locked and says Connecting APIs needs approval. Ask your administrator to turn on Can add API sources for one of your groups.
- **Create** the base, then check its row in the table: it shows the status, the security posture, and whether the base is enabled.

GOOD TO KNOW

Only enabled knowledge bases can be searched from chat, and access control is enforced per source — people only ever retrieve what they are allowed to see.

Using knowledge in a conversation

- Type # in the composer to reference a knowledge source or choose from Files in knowledge sources. A file choice references its name in your prompt and searches that file's knowledge source; the row says which source will be searched.
- Or turn on the **Knowledge** switch in send options to let the reply search your enabled bases.
- Replies grounded in knowledge return citations that link straight back to the source documents.

GOOD TO KNOW

The # shortcut menu shows Loading files… while retrieving file choices. If Some files could not be loaded appears, use Retry in that menu. Files from sources that loaded successfully remain usable. If access was removed or a source needs configuration, ask your administrator to resolve it.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:24 · HELP › LEARN

Knowledge bases

Create a knowledge base from files, web pages, or an API, watch it index, and ask a question that cites it.

Before you begin

- To create your own: your administrator grants Can build knowledge bases to one of your groups. Without it, you use the knowledge bases shared with you.
- Files up to 250 MB each: PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, email (.eml, .msg), text, **Markdown**, **CSV**, JSON, images, audio, and video.
- For web pages: public addresses. For pages behind a sign-in, paste the text instead.
- To connect an API: your administrator also grants Can add API sources. Until then, **Connect an API** is shown locked.
- **Connected** sources such as SharePoint, Box, Google Drive, and iManage are set up by administrators and shared with you.

Step by step

1. Choose **Library** in the sidebar; **Knowledge** opens.
2. Choose New knowledge base.
3. Type a Name, keep Start with on Upload files, and choose **Create**. Who can search it is Only me; administrators manage sharing.
4. Drag files onto Drag files here, or choose browse your computer.
5. Wait for each file to show Added and appear under Indexed files with its passage count. The base shows Ready.
6. In a chat, type # and choose your knowledge base, then type your question and send it.
7. Check the reply: it answers from your files and offers View N citations →. Open it to see each file and passage in **Sources gathered**.

Path: Add web pages

1. In the knowledge base, open **Web** pages.
2. Type the Page address (and an optional Name), then choose Fetch and add page.
3. The page is listed under Indexed web page; Sync now fetches it again later.
4. For a page behind a sign-in, tick Paste the text instead of fetching the page, paste it, and choose Add text.

Path: Connect an API

1. Connecting an API needs Can add API sources as well. Without it, **Connect an API** shows a lock, and API says Connecting APIs needs approval.
2. Open API. Enter the API address, an optional Path and Name.

3. Under Sign-in choose None (public API), API key, Bearer token, or Sign in with provider (OAuth), and fill in its fields.
4. Choose Fetch and add. The JSON or text response becomes searchable passages; Sync now refreshes it.

Path: Ask without

1. **Send options** › **Knowledge**, then choose your knowledge base.
2. Send the question; the reply searches only that source.

Path: Turn it off or tidy it

1. The On switch (Assistants can search …) controls whether chats can search it.
2. **Delete** a file with the bin beside it under Indexed files.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Each file shows Added and is listed under Indexed files with a passage count.
- ✓ The knowledge base shows Ready and On.
- ✓ A question with # returns facts from your files and View N citations; **Sources gathered** names the file (for a PDF, with the page).

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"You can use the knowledge bases shared with you in chat. Ask an administrator if you need to add your own."	Creating knowledge bases is not granted to your groups. Ask your administrator for Can build knowledge bases.
"Skipped … (save it as .docx first)" or "(unsupported type)" or "(larger than … MB)"	Convert old .doc files to .docx, use a supported type, or split very large files.
"No readable text — only the name is searchable"	The file has no text layer (for example a picture-only PDF beyond the OCR limit). Upload a text version.
"Connecting APIs needs approval. Ask your administrator to turn on Can add API sources for one of your groups."	API sources need their own grant, on top of Can build knowledge bases. Ask your administrator. API data already indexed stays searchable.
"Give the knowledge base a name."	Type a Name before choosing **Create**.
"Enter the page address."	Type the full address, including https://.
"Some files could not be loaded. Retry" in the # menu	Choose Retry. Sources that already loaded stay usable.

25. The Tools library

MCP connections, saved prompts, and skill files inside the Library.

Click **Library** in the sidebar, then the **Tools** tab. The **Tools Library and Connectors** panel has three sections:

TAB	WHAT LIVES THERE	WHERE IT APPEARS IN CHAT
Connections	MCP tools and connections available to models and agents.	Type / in the composer.
Prompts	Saved prompt templates, including `{{variables}}` you fill in when using them.	Type / in the composer.
Skills	Skill files — reusable instructions for recurring workflows.	Type $ in the composer.

- Click **New Prompt** or **New Skill** to create one: give it a name, a category, a description, and the content itself, then save.
- Click any existing card to review or edit it; the trash icon deletes it permanently.
- Every tool row shows its real status — draft, approval required, or enabled — so you always know whether a connection is actually live before relying on it.

- Add connection is locked until an administrator grants Can build tools to one of your groups; its tooltip says so. **Hermes** connections and **Hermes** agents show **Locked** until your administrator approves **Hermes** for you.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:23 · HELP › LEARN

Tools and the Library

Find the connections, saved prompts, and skill files you can use, read them, and add a private connection when your administrator allows it.

Before you begin

- **Prompts** and skill files are created by administrators; you can read and use them.
- To add your own connection: your administrator grants Can build tools to one of your groups, and you have the MCP server's address. Until then, Add connection is shown locked.
- **Hermes** connections also need **Can use Hermes companion** on one of your groups. Until then they show **Locked**.

Step by step

1. Choose **Library** in the sidebar, then **Tools**.
2. **Connections** lists the MCP connections you can use in **Agent** mode, with On, Off, Needs setup, or **Locked**.
3. Choose **Prompts** to see the saved prompts shared with you. Choose a prompt's View to read its content.
4. Choose **Skills** to see the skill files shared with you.
5. Use them in chat: type / for prompts and connections, and $ for skill files, or attach them to an agent.

Path: Add a private connection

1. Without Can build tools, Add connection shows a lock. With it, choose Add connection.
2. Type a Name, choose how Aperture connects (HTTP or SSE), and enter the Server URL starting with https://.
3. Choose Add connection. It starts turned off; set sign-in, access, and approval on the next screen, test it, and turn it on.
4. **Connections** you add are private to you; an administrator can share them.

Path: Read a connection's status

1. On: available under policy. Off: turned off. Needs setup: missing an address, token, or sign-in.
2. Last test failed: the latest connection test did not succeed.

3. Asks before each use: you approve each run in chat (**Approve** MCP tool run?).
4. **Locked**, with Needs **Hermes** approval from your administrator: a **Hermes** connection your groups cannot use yet.

Check that it worked

- ✓ **Prompts** and **Skills** list the items shared with you, and View shows each one's content.
- ✓ Typing / in chat lists the same prompts, and $ lists the same skill files.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Connections are managed by your administrators. These are the ones you can use in Agent mode."	You cannot add connections yet. Ask your administrator for Can build tools if you need one.
Add connection is off, with a lock: "Adding your own MCP connections needs approval. Ask your administrator to turn on Can build tools for one of your groups."	Ask your administrator for Can build tools if you need your own connection.
"Locked" and "Needs Hermes approval from your administrator" on a connection	**Hermes** needs approval. Ask your administrator to turn on **Can use Hermes companion** for one of your groups.
"Shared prompts are managed by administrators." or "Skills are managed by administrators."	Ask your administrator to add or change a prompt or skill file.
"Use a full address starting with https://"	Enter the complete server address.
"Not signed in to the provider" or "No access token saved"	Open the connection's Sign-in tab and finish signing in, or ask your administrator.
"MCP tool run denied. No message was sent."	You chose Deny when asked to approve a tool run. Send again and choose **Approve** if you trust it.

26. Scheduled automations

Recurring chat or drafting runs, as one model call or a multi-step chain.

Automations are saved workflows that run a chat or drafting task on a schedule. They are useful for recurring digests, weekly status checks, report refreshes, policy reviews, and any workflow where the same model chain should run the same way each time. Enabled schedules run automatically in the background (times are UTC), and each scheduled run delivers its output as a new chat thread in your sidebar.

Creating an automation

- Click **Agents** in the sidebar, then the Automations tab, then **New automation**.
- Name it — for example “Monday client digest”.
- Choose what it runs against: chat or draft.
- Pick a trigger: **Daily** (a time each day), **Weekly** (a day and time), **Once** (a specific date and time), or **Cron expression** (such as `0 9 * * 1` for 9:00 every Monday, in UTC).
- Write the initial input — what the first step should work on.
- Build the model chain: each step has a model and an instruction, and each step's output feeds into the next step. Use **Add step** for multi-step chains and the × to remove a step.
- Click **Save automation**.

What to check before saving

- **Models** — every step must use a model you can actually access. If a model is missing, your admin may need to approve it for your group.
- Context — write the initial input as if the automation will run without you watching. Include the matter, audience, date range, source expectations, and desired output format.
- Cadence — use **Once** for a single future run, **Daily** or **Weekly** for regular recurring work, or a reviewed **Cron expression** for another schedule. All times are UTC; check the intended local-time equivalent before saving.
- Ownership — name the automation so another person can tell what it does later.

Running and managing

- Each automation card shows its schedule, its steps, and its last run with an honest result — succeeded or failed, with the reason.
- **Run now** executes the whole chain immediately and shows a transcript of every step's output.
- The toggle pauses or resumes the schedule; the pencil edits it; the trash deletes it.
- You can also queue an automation into any chat by typing > in the composer — it runs when you send.
- The list shows the automations you created. Organization administrators can review the automations in their workspace.

> **TIP**
> Always use **Run now** once after creating or editing an automation. If the run fails, the card shows the reason so you can fix the model choice, input, or instructions before depending on the saved schedule.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:42 · HELP › LEARN

Scheduled automations

Build an automation that runs a prompt through one or more models on a schedule, deliver it to a new chat or a new draft, run it now, and read its history.

Before you begin

- At least one model available to you. Without one, Automations says no approved models are available and **New automation** is off.
- The prompt you want to run, and when it should run (the time zone matters).

Step by step

1. Choose **Agents** in the sidebar, then Automations.
2. Choose **New automation**.
3. Under What it does, type a Name and the Prompt for the first step.
4. Under Steps, choose a model (or one of your agents) for step 1 and an optional instruction. Choose **Add step** to pass the result to another model.
5. Under Schedule, choose **Daily**, **Weekly**, **Once**, or Custom, set the time and Time zone, and check Next runs.
6. Under Deliver results to, choose **New chat** or New draft.
7. Leave On — runs on this schedule turned on, and choose **Save automation**.
8. On the automation's card, choose **Run now** to test it. Wait for the result and choose Open chat (or Open draft).

Path: Daily

1. How often › **Daily**, then set Time.
2. Next runs lists the coming days at that time.

Path: Weekly

1. How often › **Weekly**, choose the day (Mon to Sun), then set Time.
2. Next runs lists the coming weeks.

Path: Once

1. How often › **Once**, then set Run at to a date and time in the future.
2. Next runs shows that single run; if the time has passed it says No upcoming runs — this time has passed.

Path: Custom (cron)

1. How often › Custom, then type a **Cron expression** with five fields: minute, hour, day of month, month, day of week.
2. For example 30 7 * * 1–5 runs at 7:30 AM on weekdays. Check Next runs before saving.

Path: Deliver to a new draft

1. Under Deliver results to, choose New draft.
2. The last step is asked for a complete document, saved as a new draft.
3. After **Run now**, choose Open draft to edit and export it in **Drafts**.

Path: Pause, resume, edit

1. The switch on the card pauses the automation (Paused) or resumes it (Active).
2. Edit changes its steps, schedule, or delivery; choose Save changes.
3. Run history (N) lists recent runs: Succeeded, Failed, or Skipped, how each was started, and how long it took.

Check that it worked

- ✓ After saving, the card shows the schedule, the step chain, and Next run in ….
- ✓ **Run now** reports that the run saved the result to a new chat (or draft), and Output from this run shows each step.
- ✓ Open chat shows the delivered conversation, titled with the automation's name and the run time.
- ✓ Run history lists the run as Succeeded, run now.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"No approved models are available yet. An administrator must enable at least one available model before automations can run."	Ask your administrator for access to a model; **New automation** stays off until then.
"Give the automation a name." or "Every step needs a model or agent."	Type a Name and choose a model or agent for every step.
"Choose a date and time for the one-time run."	Set Run at for a **Once** schedule.
"Enter a cron expression, for example `0 9 * * 1`-5."	Type five fields separated by spaces, and check Next runs.
"Run failed: …" or Last run failed on the card	Read the message in Run history. A model or agent may be unavailable; edit the step and run it again.
Paused after failures	After 3 scheduled failures in a row the automation pauses itself. Fix the cause, then turn the switch back on.
An agent is listed as "(agent, needs Hermes approval)" and cannot be chosen for a step	That agent uses the **Hermes** companion. Ask your administrator to turn on **Can use Hermes companion** for one of your groups, or choose another model or agent.
An agent step does not use its tools	**Tools** and MCP servers need a person to approve them, so automations run agent steps without tools.

PART 5

Appearance, your account, and help

27. Light and dark mode

Switch appearance now or schedule it for this browser.

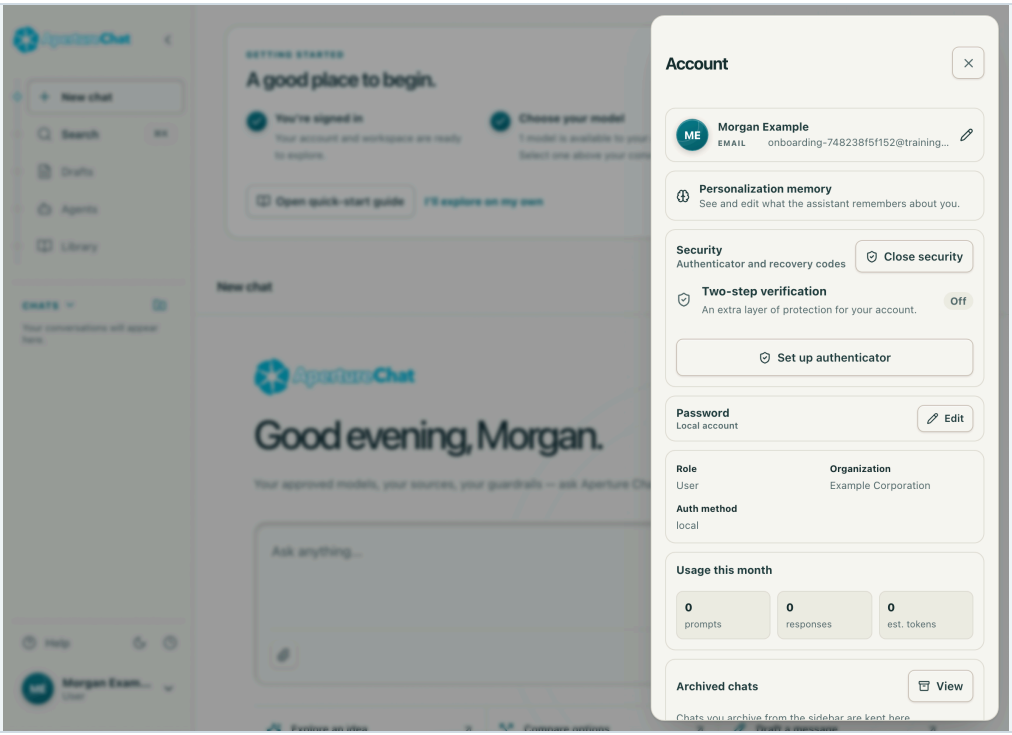
1. Find the moon or sun button beside **Help** near the bottom of the sidebar — a moon (**Dark mode**) while in light mode, a sun (**Light mode**) while in dark mode.
2. Click it. The entire platform switches immediately — no reload, nothing to save.
3. Click it again to switch back.

Schedule light and dark mode

Choose the clock button beside it to open **Theme schedule**. Enable **Switch automatically**, set different **Light mode at** and **Dark mode at** times, then choose **Save schedule**. The schedule uses this device's local time every day and is saved in this browser. You can still switch manually until the next scheduled change; disable the switch to stop automatic changes.

28. Your account

Your profile, personalization memory, password, role previews, usage, archives, and signing out.



Your account includes profile settings, password controls, and two-step verification. Example workspace with synthetic data.

Click your account card (your initials or photo) at the very bottom of the sidebar. The account drawer opens with everything about you in one place.

- **Profile** — click the card with your name and the pencil icon to edit your display name, firm, website, bio, phone number, and photo (upload an image up to 5 MB, or paste a URL). Click **Save profile** when done, or **Cancel** to discard.
- **Management** — administrators and platform owners see this section, listing the consoles they can open; the sidebar's **Admin console** and Platform console links go to the same places. Regular users do not have it.
- Personalization memory — opens your private memory manager when the feature is enabled. Use it to control, review, add, correct, pin, forget, or clear what the assistant remembers about you.
- **Password** — accounts that sign in with a password can change it here (click the pencil, enter the current password, then the new one twice — at least 12 characters). The app continues with a new authenticated session after saving and revokes previous sessions. Accounts that sign in through **SSO** manage their password with the **SSO** provider instead, and the panel says so.
- **Security** — choose **Manage security** to set up an authenticator for a local account, review the remaining recovery-code count, or replace codes after verifying your identity. Turning verification off is available only when organization policy permits it and signs you out. **SSO** accounts follow their identity-provider settings for voluntary enrollment.

- Role and organization — your role, your organization, any personal token caps that apply to you, and how you sign in.
- **View as** — if your role allows it, preview the workspace exactly as a lower role would see it. A note reminds you which role you are previewing; switch back the same way.
- **Usage this month** — your prompts, responses, and estimated tokens.
- **Archived chats** — every chat you have archived, with buttons to restore each one to your sidebar or delete it permanently.
- **Sign out** — ends your session and returns to the sign-in screen.

WALKTHROUGH · 2:08 · HELP › LEARN

Personalize, use mobile, and get help

Edit your profile, choose light or dark mode and a theme schedule, install the app on a phone, tablet, or computer, and find Help.

Before you begin

- For installing: Safari on iPhone or iPad, Chrome on Android, or Chrome or Edge on a computer.

Step by step

1. Select your account card at the bottom of the sidebar, then the pencil beside your name (Edit account profile).
2. Change the fields you need, such as Phone number or Firm or organization, and choose **Save profile**. **Profile** saved confirms it.
3. Choose the moon button beside **Help** for **Dark mode**, or the sun for **Light mode**.
4. Choose the clock button (**Theme schedule**), turn on **Switch automatically**, set **Light mode at** and **Dark mode at** to different times, and choose **Save schedule**.
5. Choose **Help** at the bottom of the sidebar. It holds Report a problem, My reports, the walkthroughs, and the printable User guide (PDF).
6. To send a problem, idea, question, feedback, or security concern and follow the replies, see Report a problem and follow it up.

Path: iPhone or iPad (Safari)

1. Open your workspace address in Safari and sign in. Add Aperture Chat to your home screen opens (or choose **Install app** in the menu).
2. Tap the **Share** button in the browser toolbar.
3. Scroll the share sheet and choose Add to Home Screen.
4. Tap Add. Aperture Chat appears on your home screen and opens full screen.

Path: Android (Chrome)

1. Open your workspace address in Chrome and sign in. The install card opens (or choose **Install app** in the menu).
2. If it offers **Install app**, choose it and confirm in the phone's install sheet.
3. Otherwise open the browser's ⋮ menu and choose Add to Home screen or **Install app**, then confirm.

Path: Computer (Chrome or Edge)

1. Aperture Chat shows no install card on computers.
2. Use the browser's own install control: the install icon at the right of the address bar, or the browser menu › Install (Chrome: Cast, save, and share › Install page as app; Edge: Apps › Install this site as an app).
3. Confirm Install. The app opens in its own window and appears with your other apps.

Path: On a narrow screen

1. Choose Open menu (top left) to reach navigation, chats, **Help**, **Install app**, and your account.
2. Choose where to go; the menu closes. The same permissions apply as on a computer.

Check that it worked

- ✓ **Profile** saved appears, and your account card shows the new details.
- ✓ The workspace switches between light and dark at the scheduled times on this device.
- ✓ The installed app opens from your home screen or app list.
- ✓ **Help** opens with Report a problem and My reports at the top.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Use a complete http(s) website URL."	Enter the full website address, including https://.
"Choose a profile photo that is 5 MB or smaller."	Use a smaller image.
"Choose two different times."	**Light mode at** and **Dark mode at** must differ.
Help shows a dot	One of your reports has a reply or a new status. Open **Help** › My reports (see Report a problem and follow it up).

29. Personalization memory

Save and recall private preferences in plain English across chats and sessions.

Personalization memory belongs to your account, not to one conversation. When service policy and your organization administrator allow it, administrators and regular users can each build their own private memory. A saved item can influence a new chat immediately and still be available after you sign out and return in a later session.

Save a memory in ordinary English

- In any chat, state what should persist in natural language — for example: “Remember that I prefer a short summary before the detail,” “Please remember that I work in commercial litigation,” or “Remember my project codename is Silver Horizon.”
- Send the message. The assistant confirms the memory after it is saved; you do not need a slash command or special syntax.
- Start a new chat, or return in a later sign-in session, and ask a natural question such as “What do you remember about me?”, “What are my writing preferences?”, or “What is my project codename?” The same account memory is available across those sessions.

GOOD TO KNOW

Memory is different from the context window shown in Session details. The context window describes how much of the current chat the selected model can hold at once; personalization memory is durable account context that follows you into other chats and sessions.

Open and control the memory manager

- Click your account card — your name and role at the bottom-left of the sidebar.
- Click Personalization memory. The dialog titled “What the assistant remembers about you” opens.
- Use memory in my chats controls whether saved items are applied to answers. Learn from my conversations controls whether the assistant may notice durable preferences automatically. Turning a switch off does not expose or silently erase existing items.
- To add something directly, type it under Add something you want remembered, choose Standing instructions, Preferences, About you, Your work, or Other details, and click Add.
- Review the list below. Click a memory's wording to correct it; pin an important item; use Forget to remove one item; or choose Forget everything to clear the list.

GOOD TO KNOW

Only you can read your memory content. Administrators can see counts and purge memories for compliance, but the platform never shows them what an individual memory says.

TIP

If Personalization memory is missing from your account drawer, the feature is not currently available at the platform, organization, or group level. Ask your administrator; refreshing the page cannot override that policy.

CAREFUL

Do not use memory as a password or secret vault. Credentials, keys, and sensitive identifiers are rejected on purpose.

WALKTHROUGH · 1:28 · HELP › LEARN

Personalization memory

Save preferences in plain English, recall them in later sessions, and stay in control.

Before you begin

- Memory must be allowed by your platform and your organization. If it is off, the Personalization memory row says why.
- Only you can read your memories. Administrators see how many you have and can delete them, but never read them.

Step by step

1. Select your account card at the bottom of the sidebar and choose Personalization memory.
2. Check Use memory in my chats (applies saved memories to answers) and Learn from my conversations (lets the assistant notice lasting preferences itself).
3. Type a memory in Add something you want remembered, choose its type (for example Preferences), and choose Add.
4. Choose Pin on a memory that should always apply. Choose its text to correct the wording.
5. In any chat, say Remember that … followed by the preference; it is saved for later chats.
6. In a new chat, ask a question the memory answers, and check that the reply uses it.

Path: Forget

1. Personalization memory › Forget on one memory removes it.
2. Forget everything asks Forget all …? This cannot be undone. before removing them all.

Path: Turn memory off

1. Turn off Use memory in my chats to stop applying memories. Saved memories stay private and manageable.
2. Turn off Learn from my conversations to save only what you add or ask it to remember.

Check that it worked

- ✓ The memory is listed in Personalization memory under its type, with Pin on if you pinned it.
- ✓ After Remember that … in chat, the sentence appears in the list.
- ✓ A later chat's reply uses it without being told again.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Memories cannot contain credentials, keys, or sensitive identifiers."	Passwords, keys, tokens, one-time codes, and card or account numbers are never stored. Keep them out of memory.
"Write a little more so the memory is useful later."	Write a full phrase of at least a few words.
"Pinned memories already fill your memory limit. Unpin or forget one before saving more."	Unpin or forget a memory, then add the new one.
"That memory kind is disabled by your organization's policy."	Choose another type, or ask your administrator.
The row says memory is turned off	"Memory is turned off for this platform.", "… for your organization.", or your groups' policy: ask your administrator. "You turned memory off for your account.": turn it back on here.
No note under the reply says a memory was saved or used	The reply does not currently show that note. Check Personalization memory to confirm the memory was saved.

30. Install the app on your phone

Put your workspace on the home screen with its own icon and name.

On a phone or tablet, tap **Install app** near the bottom of the sidebar. The “Add … to your home screen” dialog previews your organization's app name and icon.

- On Android, choose **Install app** if offered, then follow the native install sheet. Otherwise open your browser's menu and choose “Add to Home screen” or “**Install app**”.
- On iPhone and iPad, tap the browser's **Share** button, scroll the share sheet, choose “Add to Home Screen”, then tap Add.
- Open the new home-screen icon to return to the same workspace in a full-screen app.

31. Getting help

Walkthrough videos and this guide, always one click away.

- Click **Help** at the bottom of the sidebar for guided videos, captions, transcripts, and this PDF. The guide also covers additional procedures.
- Administrators can also open **Documentation** inside the console for role-specific videos and a printable guide.
- Choose Report a problem in **Help** to describe a problem, the affected screen, and the expected result. **Share** only permitted details with your administrators; omit passwords, keys, and recovery codes.
- Choose My reports in **Help** to see each report's status (Received, In review, In progress, On hold, Resolved, or Closed), read replies, answer questions, or reopen a report that is still a problem.

WALKTHROUGH · 4:06 · HELP › LEARN

Report a problem and follow it up

Send a problem, idea, question, feedback, or security concern to your administrators, then follow its status, answer replies, and reopen it in My reports.

Before you begin

- Any signed-in account. No permission is needed to report.
- What you were doing, what you expected, and what happened. For a problem, the steps that make it happen again.
- Optionally, a screenshot (**PNG**, JPEG, GIF, or WebP, up to 10 MB) with no passwords or personal data.
- Your administrators answer reports in their **Admin console** › Reports.

Step by step

1. Choose **Help** at the bottom of the sidebar, then Report a problem.
2. Under What would you like to send?, choose Problem.
3. Under How much is this affecting you?, choose Blocking me, Slows me down, or Minor.
4. Type a short Subject. In Message, describe what you did, what you expected, and what happened.
5. Optionally add a screenshot: Choose image, Capture screen, or paste or drop an image into the form.
6. Leave Include technical details ticked to send the page, browser, and recent errors (What's included lists them). No chat content is attached.
7. Choose Send report and wait for Report #… sent.

8. Choose View status. My reports opens the report with its tracker at Received.
9. When **Help** shows a dot, choose **Help** › My reports and open the report to read the reply from Support team.
10. To answer, type in Add a reply and choose Send reply.
11. When it is resolved, find it under Closed in My reports.

Path: Idea, Question, or Feedback

1. **Help** › Report a problem, then choose Idea, Question, or Feedback.
2. The form skips How much is this affecting you? and changes its prompts: Idea asks what you'd like to do and the problem it would solve; Question asks anything about how the platform works; Feedback asks what's working well or could be better.
3. Fill in Subject and Message and choose Send report. Follow it in My reports like a problem.

Path: Security

1. **Help** › Report a problem, then choose **Security**.
2. Read the notice: **Security** concerns go only to your administrators and are never posted publicly.
3. Describe what you noticed and where. Do not include passwords, keys, or personal data.
4. Choose Send report. My reports lists it as a **Security** concern.

Path: With a screenshot

1. Choose image picks a file from your device. You can also paste an image, or drop one onto the Screenshot area.
2. Capture screen asks your browser to share the screen; choose this tab. The report panel hides itself for the picture, so the screenshot shows the page behind it.
3. Check the thumbnail for passwords or personal data. Remove screenshot (×) takes it off.
4. **PNG**, JPEG, GIF, or WebP images up to 10 MB are accepted.

Path: Reopen a resolved report

1. **Help** › My reports › Closed, then open the report.
2. Under Still having this problem?, optionally say what is still happening.
3. Choose **Reopen** report. It moves back to Open at Received, and your administrators see that you reopened it.

Check that it worked

- ✓ Report #… sent appeared after Send report.

- ✓ **Help** › My reports lists the report with its type, when it was last updated, and its status.
- ✓ The report's tracker and conversation show each status change and every reply.
- ✓ After **Reopen** report, the report is listed under Open again, at Received.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Add both a subject and a message."	Fill in Subject and Message, then choose Send report.
"Choose a PNG, JPEG, GIF, or WebP image." or "Choose a screenshot that is 10 MB or smaller."	Attach a smaller image in one of those formats, or send the report without a screenshot.
"This browser can't capture the screen."	Take a screenshot with your device's own tool, then use Choose image, or paste it into the form.
"The issue report could not be sent."	The report was not received. Check your connection and choose Send report again. The form keeps what you typed in this browser tab.
"You're sending these very quickly. Wait a moment and try again."	You can send up to four reports and ten replies a minute. Wait a minute, then send again.
"This report is closed. Reopen it to add more detail."	It was resolved or closed while you were writing. Go back to My reports, open it, and choose **Reopen** report.
"Your reports could not be loaded."	Check your connection, then open **Help** › My reports again.
No dot on Help after a reply	The workspace checks for news when the page loads and whenever you open **Help** or close a panel. Open **Help** › My reports to check.